57 bài mẫu IELTS Writing Task 2 — Health & Sport

Từ và cụm quan trọng được tô màu; cuối mỗi bài là các cụm cần nhớ kèm nghĩa. Điểm do AI chấm, chỉ để tham khảo.

Cụm từ | Từ đồng nghĩa | Từ nối | Khung câu | Câu mang ý | Câu ví dụ

Advantages / Disadvantages

#5 Advantages / Disadvantages · 281 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.0)

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on health? Use examples.

Health is often treated as a private matter, yet a country's wealth depends heavily on the wellbeing of its people. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on health: a stronger economy and a better quality of life.

First and foremost, a focus on health strengthens the economy. Healthier people are more productive and cost less in the long run. A healthy workforce takes fewer sick days, works more efficiently and supports economic growth, and fewer families are pushed into poverty by medical bills. Prevention and early treatment are also much cheaper than emergency care, so spending on health frees money for other uses. A country that provides vaccination and clean water, for example, spends far less on treating diseases that could have been avoided. Healthy children also learn better at school, which builds a more skilled population for the future.

In addition, a focus on health improves quality of life and social stability. People live longer and enjoy their later years in better condition, and families are spared the grief and burden of preventable illness. Strong health services also make the country safer, since they can respond quickly to epidemics and disasters. Where health care is available to everyone, people feel more secure and more equal, which supports trust in public institutions. Although providing good health services is expensive, a nation that invests in the wellbeing of its people gains a more productive, more cohesive society, and the returns continue across generations.

To sum up, focusing on health brings clear benefits to a country, above all a stronger economy and a better, more secure quality of life. For these reasons, it deserves sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a private matter** — chuyện riêng tư
- **depends heavily on the wellbeing of its people** — phụ thuộc nhiều vào sức khoẻ tinh thần và thể chất của người dân
- **a stronger economy** — nền kinh tế mạnh hơn
- **a better quality of life** — chất lượng sống tốt hơn
- **strengthens the economy** — củng cố nền kinh tế
- **more productive and cost less in the long run** — năng suất hơn và tốn ít chi phí hơn về lâu dài
- **A healthy workforce** — lực lượng lao động khoẻ mạnh
- **takes fewer sick days** — ít ngày nghỉ ốm hơn
- **supports economic growth** — hỗ trợ tăng trưởng kinh tế
- **pushed into poverty by medical bills** — bị đẩy vào cảnh nghèo vì hoá đơn y tế
- **Prevention and early treatment** — phòng bệnh và điều trị sớm
- **frees money for other uses** — giải phóng tiền cho mục đích khác
- **vaccination and clean water** — tiêm chủng và nước sạch
- **diseases that could have been avoided** — bệnh có thể tránh được
- **learn better at school** — học tốt hơn ở trường
- **a more skilled population** — dân số có tay nghề hơn
- **social stability** — sự ổn định xã hội
- **live longer** — sống lâu hơn
- **enjoy their later years** — tận hưởng những năm cuối đời
- **spared the grief and burden of preventable illness** — tránh được đau buồn và gánh nặng của bệnh phòng được
- **respond quickly to epidemics and disasters** — ứng phó nhanh với dịch bệnh và thiên tai
- **feel more secure and more equal** — cảm thấy an toàn và bình đẳng hơn
- **trust in public institutions** — niềm tin vào các thể chế công
- **a more productive, more cohesive society** — xã hội năng suất và gắn kết hơn
- **across generations** — qua nhiều thế hệ
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

#28 Advantages / Disadvantages · 274 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.0)

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of private healthcare.

In many countries patients can choose between public hospitals and private clinics paid for by insurance or by themselves. This essay will discuss the main advantages and disadvantages of private healthcare before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, private healthcare offers shorter waiting times and more choice. Patients who pay can often see a specialist within days, choose their doctor and enjoy comfortable facilities, and competition encourages clinics to adopt new equipment and improve service. A patient who needs a knee replacement, for example, may be treated within weeks in a private hospital but wait a year in a public one. The public system is also relieved of some pressure, because privately treated patients do not use its beds. In addition, private hospitals often invest quickly in modern machines and training, which can benefit the whole medical field.

On the negative side, however, a profit-driven system can leave the poor behind. Those who can pay receive faster and better care while others wait, which creates a two-tier system. Companies may encourage unnecessary tests or neglect conditions that make little profit, and private clinics can draw doctors away from public hospitals, making shortages worse where they are most serious. A family without insurance, for example, may delay taking a sick child to a doctor until the illness becomes serious. Private care can also be very expensive, and insurance premiums rise sharply with age and illness.

In conclusion, private healthcare brings speed and choice, but it risks inequality and weaker public services. On balance, I believe that it is acceptable as a supplement to a strong public system, but it should not replace it.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **public hospitals and private clinics** — bệnh viện công và phòng khám tư
- **paid for by insurance** — được trả bằng bảo hiểm
- **private healthcare** — y tế tư nhân
- **shorter waiting times and more choice** — thời gian chờ ngắn hơn và nhiều lựa chọn hơn
- **see a specialist within days** — gặp chuyên gia trong vài ngày
- **comfortable facilities** — cơ sở vật chất thoải mái
- **adopt new equipment** — áp dụng thiết bị mới
- **a knee replacement** — ca thay khớp gối
- **relieved of some pressure** — bớt một phần áp lực
- **invest quickly in modern machines and training** — nhanh chóng đầu tư máy móc hiện đại và đào tạo
- **a profit-driven system** — hệ thống chạy theo lợi nhuận
- **leave the poor behind** — bỏ lại người nghèo
- **a two-tier system** — hệ thống hai tầng
- **unnecessary tests** — xét nghiệm không cần thiết
- **make little profit** — ít lợi nhuận
- **draw doctors away from public hospitals** — kéo bác sĩ rời bệnh viện công
- **shortages worse** — thiếu hụt tệ hơn
- **delay taking a sick child to a doctor** — trì hoãn đưa đứa trẻ ốm đi khám
- **insurance premiums rise sharply** — phí bảo hiểm tăng mạnh
- **public services** — dịch vụ công
- **as a supplement** — như một phần bổ trợ

#99 Advantages / Disadvantages · 274 từ · AI 7.0 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Do the advantages of vegetarian diets outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

More people are choosing to give up meat, whether for health, environmental or ethical reasons. This essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of vegetarian diets before explaining whether the advantages outweigh the disadvantages.

On the positive side, a well-planned vegetarian diet is good for health and the environment. People who eat more vegetables, fruit, beans and whole grains tend to have lower risks of heart disease and some other illnesses, and producing plant foods generally uses less land, water and energy than producing meat. Vegetarian diets also reduce the number of animals raised and slaughtered for food, which appeals to many people on ethical grounds. A person who replaces red meat with lentils and vegetables several times a week, for example, can reduce both their fat intake and their carbon footprint. Many vegetarians also report that they feel lighter and more energetic.

On the negative side, there are some risks. Vegetarians must make sure that they get enough vitamin B12, iron, protein and other nutrients that are plentiful in meat, otherwise they may become tired or ill. Poorly planned diets, such as those relying on chips and cheese, can be unhealthy. Eating out or sharing meals with others can also be inconvenient, and choice may be limited in some places. Nevertheless, these problems are easily managed with knowledge, careful planning and, where necessary, supplements. Dieticians and clear labels can help people to build a balanced diet. With these supports, a vegetarian diet can suit people of all ages.

In conclusion, the advantages of vegetarian diets outweigh the disadvantages, provided that meals are carefully planned to include all the nutrients that the body needs.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **give up meat** — bỏ ăn thịt
- **health, environmental or ethical reasons** — lý do sức khoẻ, môi trường hoặc đạo đức
- **vegetarian diets** — chế độ ăn chay
- **a well-planned vegetarian diet** — chế độ ăn chay được lên kế hoạch tốt
- **vegetables, fruit, beans and whole grains** — rau, trái cây, đậu và ngũ cốc nguyên hạt
- **lower risks of heart disease** — nguy cơ bệnh tim thấp hơn
- **uses less land, water and energy** — dùng ít đất, nước và năng lượng hơn
- **animals raised and slaughtered for food** — động vật bị nuôi và giết để lấy thức ăn
- **on ethical grounds** — vì lý do đạo đức
- **replaces red meat with lentils and vegetables** — thay thịt đỏ bằng đậu lăng và rau
- **fat intake** — lượng chất béo nạp vào
- **carbon footprint** — dấu chân carbon
- **feel lighter and more energetic** — cảm thấy nhẹ nhàng và đầy năng lượng
- **vitamin B12, iron, protein** — vitamin B12, sắt, đạm
- **plentiful in meat** — dồi dào trong thịt
- **become tired or ill** — trở nên mệt mỏi hoặc ốm
- **Poorly planned diets** — chế độ ăn lên kế hoạch kém
- **Eating out** — ăn ngoài
- **choice may be limited** — lựa chọn có thể bị hạn chế
- **careful planning** — lập kế hoạch cẩn thận
- **a balanced diet** — chế độ ăn cân bằng

#137 Advantages / Disadvantages · 286 từ · AI 8.0 (chấm chéo 7.0)

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on public health campaigns? Use examples.

Many illnesses, from heart disease to infections, could be avoided if people knew how to protect themselves. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on public health campaigns: improved health and behaviour, and lower costs and a stronger economy.

First and foremost, public health campaigns reach millions of people at a low cost per person. Television, social media, schools and posters can spread simple, repeated messages about smoking, handwashing, vaccination or diet, and well-known figures and real stories make the advice memorable. A campaign that shows the real story of a former smoker, for example, can persuade more people to quit than a list of statistics. As a result, habits change gradually, fewer people become ill, and the whole population becomes more aware of how to stay healthy. Campaigns also reduce stigma around subjects such as mental health and sexual health, which encourages people to seek help earlier.

In addition, public health campaigns lower costs and strengthen the economy. Preventing illness is cheaper than treating it, so every unit of money spent on prevention can save several times as much on hospitals and medicine. Healthy people take fewer sick days and work more productively, which supports economic growth. Countries that have run long campaigns against smoking have seen smoking rates fall and fewer people develop lung disease. Although campaigns do not work alone and need to be supported by services and rules, their wide reach makes them one of the most cost-effective tools available, and the results are likely to last for generations.

To sum up, public health campaigns bring clear benefits to a country, above all healthier behaviour and lower long-term costs. For these reasons, they deserve sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Many illnesses** — nhiều bệnh
- **could be avoided** — có thể tránh được
- **public health campaigns** — chiến dịch y tế công cộng
- **improved health and behaviour** — sức khoẻ và hành vi được cải thiện
- **lower costs and a stronger economy** — chi phí thấp hơn và nền kinh tế mạnh hơn
- **reach millions of people at a low cost per person** — tiếp cận hàng triệu người với chi phí thấp trên mỗi người
- **simple, repeated messages** — thông điệp đơn giản, lặp lại
- **handwashing, vaccination or diet** — rửa tay, tiêm chủng hoặc chế độ ăn
- **well-known figures and real stories** — người nổi tiếng và câu chuyện thật
- **make the advice memorable** — khiến lời khuyên dễ nhớ
- **the real story of a former smoker** — câu chuyện thật của một người từng hút thuốc
- **persuade more people to quit** — thuyết phục nhiều người bỏ thuốc hơn
- **a list of statistics** — một danh sách số liệu
- **habits change gradually** — thói quen thay đổi dần dần
- **stay healthy** — giữ sức khoẻ
- **reduce stigma around** — giảm kỳ thị quanh
- **seek help earlier** — tìm sự giúp đỡ sớm hơn
- **every unit of money spent on prevention** — mỗi đồng chi cho phòng bệnh
- **fewer sick days** — ít ngày nghỉ ốm hơn
- **supports economic growth** — hỗ trợ tăng trưởng kinh tế
- **smoking rates fall** — tỷ lệ hút thuốc giảm
- **cost-effective** — hiệu quả về chi phí
- **last for generations** — kéo dài qua nhiều thế hệ
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

#248 Advantages / Disadvantages · 274 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of privatized healthcare systems.

Some countries have moved towards healthcare systems in which hospitals, clinics and insurance are run mainly by private companies. This essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of privatised healthcare systems before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, privatised systems can be efficient and responsive. Companies compete for patients, so they have a reason to cut waiting times, improve service and adopt new technology. Spending is less dependent on government budgets, which may reduce pressure on taxpayers, and patients usually have a wider choice of doctors and hospitals. Private managers can also make decisions quickly, without the delays that sometimes affect public bodies. A clinic that is paid according to the number of patients it treats, for example, will try to organise appointments efficiently and avoid long queues. In well-regulated markets, this competition can raise standards for everyone.

On the negative side, however, healthcare is not an ordinary product. A profit-driven system can leave the poor behind, as people without insurance or savings may be unable to afford even basic treatment. Companies may encourage unnecessary tests or neglect conditions that make little profit, and administration and advertising can swallow money that should go to patients. Unprofitable services, such as rural clinics and care for the elderly, may be closed. A rural clinic that loses money, for instance, may simply be shut, leaving a whole district without a doctor. Medical bills can also push families into debt.

In conclusion, privatised systems may be efficient, but they can exclude those who most need care. On balance, I believe that essential healthcare should remain publicly funded, with private providers playing a supporting and regulated role.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **run mainly by private companies** — chủ yếu do công ty tư nhân điều hành
- **privatised healthcare systems** — hệ thống y tế tư nhân hoá
- **efficient and responsive** — hiệu quả và nhạy bén
- **compete for patients** — cạnh tranh giành bệnh nhân
- **cut waiting times** — rút ngắn thời gian chờ
- **adopt new technology** — áp dụng công nghệ mới
- **dependent on government budgets** — phụ thuộc vào ngân sách chính phủ
- **a wider choice of doctors and hospitals** — nhiều lựa chọn bác sĩ và bệnh viện hơn
- **without the delays** — không có sự chậm trễ
- **organise appointments efficiently** — sắp xếp lịch hẹn hiệu quả
- **well-regulated markets** — thị trường được quản lý tốt
- **not an ordinary product** — không phải sản phẩm thông thường
- **a profit-driven system** — hệ thống chạy theo lợi nhuận
- **leave the poor behind** — bỏ lại người nghèo
- **without insurance or savings** — không có bảo hiểm hay tiền tiết kiệm
- **unnecessary tests** — xét nghiệm không cần thiết
- **make little profit** — ít lợi nhuận
- **administration and advertising** — hành chính và quảng cáo
- **swallow money that should go to patients** — nuốt tiền lẽ ra dành cho bệnh nhân
- **care for the elderly** — chăm sóc người cao tuổi
- **a rural clinic that loses money** — phòng khám nông thôn thua lỗ
- **push families into debt** — đẩy gia đình vào nợ nần
- **publicly funded** — do công tài trợ
- **a supporting and regulated role** — vai trò hỗ trợ và có quản lý

#279 Advantages / Disadvantages · 265 từ · AI 7.0

Do the advantages of longer life expectancy outweigh the challenges? Give reasons and examples.

Life expectancy has risen in most countries over the past century, and many people now expect to live into their eighties. This essay will discuss the main advantages and challenges before explaining whether the advantages outweigh the challenges.

On the positive side, longer lives give people more time with their families and more time to contribute. Older people pass on experience, care for grandchildren and often keep working or volunteering well beyond the traditional retirement age. A grandparent in good health, for example, can help to look after grandchildren and pass on knowledge, which supports working parents. Longer lives also reflect progress in medicine, nutrition and living conditions, and they allow people to pursue new interests, study again or start new careers later in life. Many older people today are healthy, active and valuable members of their communities.

On the negative side, ageing populations raise serious challenges. Pensions and healthcare cost more as the number of retired people grows, while there are fewer young workers to pay taxes. Illnesses such as dementia become more common, and many older people suffer from loneliness. Nevertheless, these challenges can be managed. Governments can raise the retirement age gradually, encourage saving, invest in preventive health and community care, and support older people who wish to keep working. Technology can also help older people to live independently for longer. With this kind of planning, a longer life becomes a gift for individuals and a resource for society.

In conclusion, the advantages of longer life expectancy outweigh the challenges, provided that societies adapt through later retirement, better care and stronger communities.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Life expectancy has risen** — tuổi thọ đã tăng
- **over the past century** — trong thế kỷ qua
- **live into their eighties** — sống đến tuổi tám mươi
- **outweigh the challenges** — lớn hơn những thách thức
- **more time with their families** — nhiều thời gian hơn bên gia đình
- **more time to contribute** — nhiều thời gian hơn để đóng góp
- **pass on experience** — truyền kinh nghiệm
- **care for grandchildren** — chăm cháu
- **keep working or volunteering** — tiếp tục làm việc hoặc tình nguyện
- **well beyond the traditional retirement age** — vượt xa tuổi nghỉ hưu truyền thống
- **pass on knowledge** — truyền lại kinh nghiệm
- **supports working parents** — hỗ trợ bố mẹ đi làm
- **progress in medicine, nutrition and living conditions** — tiến bộ về y học, dinh dưỡng và điều kiện sống
- **start new careers later in life** — bắt đầu sự nghiệp mới khi đã lớn tuổi
- **healthy, active and valuable members of their communities** — thành viên khoẻ mạnh, năng động và có giá trị của cộng đồng
- **Ageing populations** — dân số già hoá
- **Pensions and healthcare cost more** — lương hưu và y tế tốn kém hơn
- **Illnesses such as dementia** — bệnh như sa sút trí tuệ
- **suffer from loneliness** — chịu cô đơn
- **can be managed** — có thể kiểm soát
- **raise the retirement age gradually** — nâng dần tuổi nghỉ hưu
- **live independently for longer** — sống độc lập lâu hơn

#303 Advantages / Disadvantages · 273 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of weight-loss interventions outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

Obesity has become a serious health problem in many countries, and interventions to help people lose weight, from surgery and drugs to structured programmes, are increasingly common. This essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages before explaining whether the advantages outweigh the disadvantages.

On the positive side, weight-loss interventions can greatly reduce the risk of serious disease. Losing weight lowers the risk of diabetes, heart disease and joint problems and improves mobility, while surgery, drugs and structured programmes help people who have failed with dieting alone. A patient with severe obesity who has stomach surgery, for example, may lose enough weight to control diabetes and walk without pain. Improved health also brings psychological benefits, as people often feel more confident and energetic, and healthcare costs fall over time. For some patients, these treatments are the only realistic path to a healthier life. Their success shows how much suffering can be avoided when treatment is available.

On the negative side, however, there are real risks and costs. Surgery carries the danger of complications and requires permanent changes to eating habits, and drugs may have side effects and be very expensive. Many people regain weight after stopping a programme, and an excessive focus on appearance can lead to unhealthy attitudes to food and even eating disorders. Nevertheless, these problems can be reduced if interventions are supervised by qualified professionals, offered to those with a genuine medical need and combined with advice on diet, exercise and mental health.

In conclusion, the advantages of weight-loss interventions outweigh the disadvantages for people at serious medical risk, provided that treatment is carefully supervised and supported over the long term.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a serious health problem** — một vấn đề sức khoẻ nghiêm trọng
- **structured programmes** — chương trình có cấu trúc
- **weight-loss interventions** — can thiệp giảm cân
- **reduce the risk of serious disease** — giảm nguy cơ bệnh nặng
- **Losing weight lowers the risk of** — giảm cân làm giảm nguy cơ
- **joint problems** — vấn đề về khớp
- **improves mobility** — cải thiện khả năng vận động
- **failed with dieting alone** — thất bại khi chỉ ăn kiêng
- **severe obesity** — béo phì nặng
- **stomach surgery** — phẫu thuật dạ dày
- **control diabetes** — kiểm soát tiểu đường
- **walk without pain** — đi lại không đau
- **psychological benefits** — lợi ích tâm lý
- **confident and energetic** — tự tin và tràn đầy năng lượng
- **healthcare costs fall over time** — chi phí y tế giảm dần theo thời gian
- **the danger of complications** — nguy cơ biến chứng
- **permanent changes to eating habits** — thay đổi vĩnh viễn thói quen ăn
- **regain weight** — tăng cân trở lại
- **eating disorders** — rối loạn ăn uống
- **a genuine medical need** — nhu cầu y tế thật sự

#339 Advantages / Disadvantages · 284 từ · AI 8.0

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on child nutrition programs? Use examples.

Hunger and poor nutrition still hold back millions of children, even in countries that are not poor. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on child nutrition programmes: healthier, better-performing children, and long-term savings and opportunity.

First and foremost, child nutrition programmes help children to grow, learn and stay healthy. Well-fed children concentrate better, attend school more regularly and suffer fewer illnesses, so they are more likely to finish their education. A child who receives a free school breakfast, for example, is less likely to feel tired and distracted in morning lessons. Programmes that provide meals, milk, fruit or vitamins also reduce stunting and anaemia, which can harm a child's development for life. Teachers report that children who eat properly behave better, and parents on low incomes are relieved of a daily worry.

In addition, nutrition programmes bring long-term savings and opportunity. Healthier children grow into healthier adults who work more productively and need less medical care, so the cost of the programme is repaid many times over. Because poor children benefit most, the programmes help to break the cycle of poverty, since education and health are the main routes out of it. They can also support local farmers if schools buy fresh produce from nearby farms, and they teach children about food and cooking. Although providing meals requires organisation and money, careful targeting and local sourcing can keep costs under control. Countries such as Brazil and India have run large school meal schemes, which suggests that this approach is practical.

To sum up, child nutrition programmes bring clear benefits to a country, above all healthier, better-educated children and long-term savings. For these reasons, they deserve sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Hunger and poor nutrition** — đói và dinh dưỡng kém
- **hold back millions of children** — kìm hãm hàng triệu trẻ em
- **child nutrition programmes** — chương trình dinh dưỡng trẻ em
- **healthier, better-performing children** — trẻ khoẻ mạnh và học tốt hơn
- **long-term savings and opportunity** — tiết kiệm dài hạn và cơ hội
- **grow, learn and stay healthy** — lớn lên, học tập và giữ sức khoẻ
- **Well-fed children concentrate better** — trẻ được ăn đủ tập trung tốt hơn
- **attend school more regularly** — đi học đều hơn
- **suffer fewer illnesses** — ít bị bệnh hơn
- **a free school breakfast** — bữa sáng miễn phí ở trường
- **feel tired and distracted** — thấy mệt và mất tập trung
- **stunting and anaemia** — còi cọc và thiếu máu
- **harm a child's development for life** — gây hại sự phát triển của trẻ suốt đời
- **relieved of a daily worry** — được giải toả nỗi lo hằng ngày
- **healthier adults** — người lớn khoẻ mạnh hơn
- **repaid many times over** — được hoàn trả nhiều lần
- **break the cycle of poverty** — phá vỡ vòng nghèo
- **the main routes out of it** — con đường chính để thoát khỏi nó
- **support local farmers** — ủng hộ nông dân địa phương
- **buy fresh produce from nearby farms** — mua nông sản tươi từ trang trại gần đó
- **careful targeting and local sourcing** — nhắm đúng đối tượng và mua nguồn địa phương
- **school meal schemes** — chương trình bữa ăn học đường
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

#359 Advantages / Disadvantages · 284 từ · AI 7.5

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on early disease detection programs? Use examples.

Many serious diseases are easier to treat if they are found early, and some countries run programmes to test large numbers of people before symptoms appear. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on early disease detection programmes: better survival and health, and savings for the health system and economy.

First and foremost, detecting disease early makes treatment simpler, cheaper and more successful. Screening for cancer, diabetes and heart disease finds problems before symptoms appear, when a small operation or medicine may be enough, whereas late discovery needs long and costly care. A woman whose breast cancer is found at a routine scan, for example, may need only a small operation and be back at work within weeks. As a result, more people survive, suffer less and keep their independence. Children can also be checked for hearing and vision problems, so that they receive help before they fall behind at school.

In addition, early detection brings savings and economic benefits. Treating advanced disease requires long hospital stays, expensive drugs and sometimes lifelong care, while early treatment costs much less. Healthy workers remain productive, and families are spared the loss of income and the emotional strain of serious illness. Although screening programmes require equipment, trained staff and public awareness, and sometimes produce false alarms, these costs are small compared with the benefits. Wider use of simple tests, such as blood pressure checks, can also be extended to rural areas through mobile services, so that everyone benefits and inequalities in health are reduced.

To sum up, early disease detection programmes bring clear benefits to a country, above all better survival and lower costs. For these reasons, they deserve sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **easier to treat if they are found early** — dễ điều trị hơn nếu phát hiện sớm
- **before symptoms appear** — trước khi triệu chứng xuất hiện
- **early disease detection programmes** — chương trình phát hiện bệnh sớm
- **better survival and health** — khả năng sống sót và sức khoẻ tốt hơn
- **savings for the health system and economy** — tiết kiệm cho hệ thống y tế và kinh tế
- **simpler, cheaper and more successful** — đơn giản, rẻ và thành công hơn
- **Screening for cancer, diabetes and heart disease** — sàng lọc ung thư, tiểu đường và bệnh tim
- **a small operation or medicine may be enough** — một ca mổ nhỏ hoặc thuốc có thể là đủ
- **late discovery** — phát hiện muộn
- **long and costly care** — chăm sóc dài và tốn kém
- **a routine scan** — lần chụp định kỳ
- **back at work within weeks** — đi làm lại trong vài tuần
- **keep their independence** — giữ được sự tự lập
- **hearing and vision problems** — vấn đề thính lực và thị lực
- **fall behind at school** — tụt lại ở trường
- **Treating advanced disease** — điều trị bệnh giai đoạn muộn
- **lifelong care** — chăm sóc suốt đời
- **spared the loss of income** — tránh được mất thu nhập
- **screening programmes** — chương trình sàng lọc
- **false alarms** — báo động giả
- **inequalities in health** — bất bình đẳng về sức khoẻ
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

#401 Advantages / Disadvantages · 269 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of shorter hospital stays outweigh the risks? Give reasons and examples.

Hospital stays have become much shorter in many countries, with some patients going home on the day of an operation. This essay will discuss the advantages and the risks before explaining whether the advantages outweigh them.

On the positive side, shorter hospital stays lower costs and free beds for other patients. Modern techniques such as keyhole surgery and better pain relief allow earlier recovery, and patients at home avoid hospital infections and recover in comfort, surrounded by family. A patient who has a hip replacement and walks home within two days, for example, frees a bed for someone else on the waiting list. Hospitals can therefore treat more people with the same resources, and waiting lists become shorter. Many patients also report that they sleep better and feel less anxious in their own homes.

On the negative side, patients sent home too early may suffer complications. Problems can go unnoticed without nurses nearby, older people who live alone may lack help, and family members often have to act as unpaid carers. Some patients return to hospital, which cancels out the savings. Nevertheless, these risks can be managed. Hospitals can use clear criteria to decide who is safe to leave, arrange follow-up phone calls and home visits by nurses, and provide remote monitoring for those at greater risk. Good information for patients and families, with a number to call if something seems wrong, also gives reassurance. Taken together, these steps allow hospitals to treat more people safely.

In conclusion, the advantages of shorter hospital stays outweigh the risks, provided that patients are carefully selected and given proper support at home.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Hospital stays have become much shorter** — thời gian nằm viện đã ngắn hơn nhiều
- **on the day of an operation** — ngay trong ngày phẫu thuật
- **outweigh them** — lớn hơn chúng
- **lower costs and free beds for other patients** — giảm chi phí và giải phóng giường cho bệnh nhân khác
- **keyhole surgery** — phẫu thuật nội soi
- **better pain relief** — giảm đau tốt hơn
- **earlier recovery** — hồi phục sớm hơn
- **avoid hospital infections** — tránh nhiễm trùng bệnh viện
- **recover in comfort** — hồi phục trong sự thoải mái
- **a hip replacement** — ca thay khớp háng
- **on the waiting list** — trong danh sách chờ
- **treat more people with the same resources** — chữa cho nhiều người hơn với cùng nguồn lực
- **waiting lists** — danh sách chờ
- **sent home too early** — được cho về nhà quá sớm
- **suffer complications** — gặp biến chứng
- **go unnoticed** — không được chú ý
- **unpaid carers** — người chăm sóc không lương
- **cancels out the savings** — triệt tiêu khoản tiết kiệm
- **can be managed** — có thể kiểm soát
- **clear criteria** — tiêu chí rõ ràng
- **follow-up phone calls and home visits** — cuộc gọi theo dõi và thăm khám tại nhà
- **remote monitoring** — giám sát từ xa
- **outweigh the risks** — lớn hơn rủi ro
- **proper support** — sự hỗ trợ đúng mức

Agree / Disagree

#21 Agree / Disagree · 305 từ · AI 8.0 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Some people say that fast food is a waste of time and money. Do you agree or disagree?

Fast food is sold on almost every high street and advertised as cheap and convenient, and some people say that it is a waste of time and money. I partly agree with this view, since fast food offers poor value for money once health is considered, although it can save time in a busy day.

To begin with, fast food offers poor value for money once health is considered. A meal may be cheap and quick, but it usually contains a lot of salt, sugar and fat and little fibre, and regular eating raises the risk of obesity, diabetes and heart disease, which cost far more later in medical bills and lost working days. A family that eats takeaway meals every evening, for example, may spend twice as much as one that cooks simple dishes at home, and gain less nutrition. Cooking at home with basic ingredients such as rice, beans and vegetables is usually cheaper and healthier, and it takes little more time than queueing for a takeaway.

However, the claim that fast food wastes time is less convincing. For people who work long shifts or have young children, a quick meal can be a sensible solution on a day when there is no time to shop and cook. Eating occasionally at a fast-food restaurant is unlikely to harm a healthy person, and some outlets now offer salads, fruit and smaller portions. The problem is not the food itself but eating it too often. Governments and companies can help by publishing calorie information, reducing salt and sugar and promoting healthier options, so that busy people are not forced to choose between speed and health.

In conclusion, fast food is a poor use of money when eaten regularly, but it can save time in moments of need, so I agree only partly with the statement.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **on almost every high street** — ở hầu hết mọi con phố chính
- **cheap and convenient** — rẻ và tiện lợi
- **a waste of time and money** — lãng phí thời gian và tiền
- **poor value for money** — giá trị đồng tiền thấp
- **once health is considered** — khi tính cả sức khoẻ
- **a lot of salt, sugar and fat and little fibre** — nhiều muối, đường, chất béo và ít chất xơ
- **raises the risk of obesity, diabetes and heart disease** — làm tăng nguy cơ béo phì, tiểu đường và bệnh tim
- **medical bills and lost working days** — hoá đơn y tế và ngày công mất đi
- **takeaway meals** — đồ ăn mang đi
- **gain less nutrition** — nhận được ít dinh dưỡng hơn
- **basic ingredients** — nguyên liệu cơ bản
- **queueing for a takeaway** — xếp hàng mua đồ mang đi
- **work long shifts** — làm ca dài
- **a sensible solution** — giải pháp hợp lý
- **no time to shop and cook** — không có thời gian đi chợ và nấu
- **smaller portions** — khẩu phần nhỏ hơn
- **eating it too often** — ăn quá thường xuyên
- **publishing calorie information** — công bố thông tin calo
- **reducing salt and sugar** — giảm muối và đường
- **healthier options** — lựa chọn lành mạnh hơn
- **a poor use of money** — cách dùng tiền kém

#195 Agree / Disagree · 289 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Some believe that public smoking bans improve public health. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Many countries have banned smoking in restaurants, offices and other public places, and some people believe that these bans improve public health. I largely agree, since they reduce exposure to smoke and help people to quit, although the size of the effect depends on how well the bans are enforced.

To begin with, smoking bans reduce exposure to harmful smoke and encourage people to quit. Second-hand smoke causes heart disease, lung disease and asthma among non-smokers, and when smoking is no longer allowed in public it becomes less normal and harder to continue. A waiter who works eight hours a day in a smoky restaurant, for example, breathes in harmful smoke even though he has never smoked, and a ban removes that risk completely. After bans were introduced in several countries, hospitals reported fewer admissions for heart attacks and breathing problems, which suggests that the policy works. Fewer opportunities to smoke also help smokers who are trying to cut down.

Furthermore, bans protect groups who cannot choose. Children, pregnant women and people with asthma suffer most from smoky air, and employees often cannot avoid it. Bans also change social attitudes, so that young people are less likely to see smoking as normal and start the habit. However, bans cannot work on their own. Smokers who are addicted need support, such as help with quitting and higher taxes on tobacco, and rules must be enforced fairly or they will be ignored. Smoking at home, where children may still be exposed, is also hard to control and needs education rather than law.

In conclusion, public smoking bans improve public health to a large extent by reducing exposure and encouraging quitting, provided that they are enforced and supported by help for smokers.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **banned smoking in restaurants, offices and other public places** — cấm hút thuốc ở nhà hàng, văn phòng và nơi công cộng khác
- **improve public health** — cải thiện sức khoẻ cộng đồng
- **help people to quit** — giúp người ta bỏ thuốc
- **reduce exposure to harmful smoke** — giảm tiếp xúc với khói độc hại
- **Second-hand smoke** — khói thuốc thụ động
- **heart disease, lung disease and asthma** — bệnh tim, bệnh phổi và hen
- **non-smokers** — người không hút thuốc
- **less normal and harder to continue** — kém bình thường và khó tiếp tục hơn
- **a smoky restaurant** — nhà hàng đầy khói
- **breathes in harmful smoke** — hít khói độc hại
- **fewer admissions for heart attacks** — ít ca nhập viện vì nhồi máu cơ tim hơn
- **breathing problems** — vấn đề hô hấp
- **cut down** — giảm bớt
- **groups who cannot choose** — những nhóm không thể lựa chọn
- **Children, pregnant women and people with asthma** — trẻ em, phụ nữ có thai và người bị hen
- **change social attitudes** — thay đổi thái độ xã hội
- **higher taxes on tobacco** — thuế thuốc lá cao hơn
- **enforced fairly** — được thực thi công bằng
- **hard to control** — khó kiểm soát
- **supported by help for smokers** — được hỗ trợ bằng sự giúp đỡ cho người hút thuốc

#206 Agree / Disagree · 278 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.5)

To what extent do you agree or disagree that college athletes should be paid?

In some countries, university sports teams attract huge crowds and television audiences, but the players are not paid. I largely agree that college athletes should be paid, since they generate large revenues but receive little in return, although payment must be organised carefully.

To begin with, college athletes generate large revenues but receive little in return. Universities and broadcasters earn millions from matches, advertising and merchandise, while players train for many hours, risk injury and struggle to study, and a scholarship may not cover their real costs. A student athlete who injures a knee in a televised match, for example, may lose both his place on the team and his scholarship, leaving him with no income and an uncertain future. Coaches and administrators are often paid very high salaries, and it seems unfair that those who create the entertainment receive nothing. Their sport is effectively a full-time job.

Furthermore, payment would recognise the time and risk involved and reduce pressure to accept illegal rewards. Many players come from poor families and cannot afford basic expenses, which makes them vulnerable to secret payments from agents. However, there are difficulties. Payment may create inequality with other students who also work hard, and smaller sports that do not earn money might lose funding if budgets are redirected. Universities may also become more concerned with winning than with education. These problems can be reduced by paying a fair share of revenue, protecting academic standards, and keeping support for sports that do not make a profit.

In conclusion, college athletes should be paid to a large extent, because they create wealth and carry real risks, provided that safeguards protect education and smaller sports.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **university sports teams** — đội thể thao đại học
- **attract huge crowds and television audiences** — thu hút đám đông và khán giả truyền hình lớn
- **college athletes should be paid** — vận động viên đại học nên được trả lương
- **generate large revenues but receive little in return** — tạo doanh thu lớn nhưng nhận lại ít
- **merchandise** — hàng hoá lưu niệm
- **train for many hours** — tập luyện nhiều giờ
- **risk injury** — đối mặt nguy cơ chấn thương
- **struggle to study** — vật lộn để học
- **cover their real costs** — đủ chi phí thực tế của họ
- **injures a knee in a televised match** — bị thương đầu gối trong trận đấu truyền hình
- **lose both his place on the team and his scholarship** — mất cả vị trí trong đội và học bổng
- **an uncertain future** — tương lai bất định
- **very high salaries** — mức lương rất cao
- **effectively a full-time job** — thực chất là công việc toàn thời gian
- **recognise the time and risk involved** — ghi nhận thời gian và rủi ro liên quan
- **secret payments from agents** — khoản tiền bí mật từ người môi giới
- **smaller sports** — các môn thể thao nhỏ hơn
- **lose funding** — mất kinh phí
- **a fair share of revenue** — phần doanh thu công bằng
- **protecting academic standards** — bảo vệ chuẩn mực học thuật

#261 Agree / Disagree · 283 từ · AI 7.5

Some people say that international sporting events are a waste of money. Do you agree or disagree?

The Olympic Games, the football World Cup and other international sporting events cost host countries enormous sums, and some people say that they are a waste of money. I disagree with this view, since they can inspire people and promote understanding between nations, although careful planning is essential.

To begin with, international sporting events can inspire people and promote understanding between nations. They create national pride, encourage young people to take up sport, and bring visitors and cultural exchange. Athletes from rival countries share a stage and a set of rules, and the sight of peaceful competition can reduce prejudice. When a local athlete wins a medal, for example, thousands of children may be inspired to join clubs, which improves health for years afterwards. Events also give nations a chance to show their culture to a worldwide audience. The shared experience of watching and celebrating can unite people across social divisions.

Furthermore, events can bring economic benefits. Visitors spend money on hotels, restaurants and transport, jobs are created in construction and tourism, and new stadiums, roads and rail links may remain after the event and be used by residents. However, the costs are real. Some stadiums built for large tournaments are rarely used afterwards, leaving cities with debts, and money spent on a sporting festival might otherwise have funded schools or hospitals. For this reason, hosts should use existing venues, share events between cities and control budgets strictly. When planned carefully, international events can be a sound investment rather than a waste.

In conclusion, I disagree that international sporting events are a waste of money, because they inspire people and bring lasting benefits, provided that they are carefully planned and costs are controlled.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **The Olympic Games, the football World Cup** — Thế vận hội, World Cup bóng đá
- **international sporting events** — sự kiện thể thao quốc tế
- **cost host countries enormous sums** — tiêu tốn của nước chủ nhà khoản tiền khổng lồ
- **a waste of money** — lãng phí tiền bạc
- **inspire people** — truyền cảm hứng cho mọi người
- **promote understanding between nations** — thúc đẩy sự hiểu biết giữa các quốc gia
- **careful planning** — lập kế hoạch cẩn thận
- **national pride** — niềm tự hào dân tộc
- **encourage young people to take up sport** — khuyến khích người trẻ chơi thể thao
- **cultural exchange** — giao lưu văn hoá
- **rival countries** — các nước đối thủ
- **peaceful competition** — cạnh tranh hoà bình
- **reduce prejudice** — giảm định kiến
- **wins a medal** — giành huy chương
- **a worldwide audience** — khán giả toàn thế giới
- **unite people across social divisions** — đoàn kết mọi người vượt qua chia rẽ xã hội
- **bring economic benefits** — mang lại lợi ích kinh tế
- **hotels, restaurants and transport** — khách sạn, nhà hàng và giao thông
- **jobs are created in construction and tourism** — việc làm được tạo ra trong xây dựng và du lịch
- **rarely used afterwards** — hiếm khi được dùng sau đó
- **leaving cities with debts** — để lại cho các thành phố nợ nần
- **use existing venues** — dùng địa điểm sẵn có
- **control budgets strictly** — kiểm soát ngân sách chặt chẽ
- **a sound investment rather than a waste** — khoản đầu tư hợp lý thay vì lãng phí
- **lasting benefits** — lợi ích lâu dài
- **controlled** — được kiểm soát

#266 Agree / Disagree · 300 từ · AI 8.0

To what extent do you agree or disagree that governments should ban smoking in public places?

Smoking harms not only the smoker but also the people around, and governments in many countries are deciding how far to restrict it. I agree that governments should ban smoking in public places, since people have a right to breathe clean air, although some flexibility may be needed outdoors.

To begin with, non-smokers have a right to breathe clean air. When smoking is allowed in enclosed places such as restaurants, offices and public transport, people who have not chosen to smoke are forced to inhale harmful smoke, which can cause asthma, heart disease and lung cancer. A waiter who works eight hours a day in a smoky restaurant, for example, breathes in harmful smoke even though he has never smoked, and he cannot easily change jobs. Children are especially at risk, since their lungs are still developing. Public places are shared by everyone, so the right to clean air should take priority over the habit of a few.

Furthermore, bans change habits and save money. They make it easier for smokers to cut down or quit, reduce litter from cigarette ends and lower the healthcare costs of smoke-related illness. Admittedly, a total ban limits personal freedom and may be difficult to enforce, particularly in open areas, and many smokers are addicted rather than careless. However, freedom to smoke does not extend to harming others, and designated outdoor areas, away from entrances and children, can balance the rights of smokers and non-smokers. Fines should be reasonable, and help for people who want to stop smoking should be widely available, so that the policy is seen as fair rather than punitive.

In conclusion, I agree that governments should ban smoking in public places, because it protects non-smokers and improves health, provided that the ban is fair and combined with support for smokers.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **harms not only the smoker but also the people around** — hại không chỉ người hút mà cả người xung quanh
- **ban smoking in public places** — cấm hút thuốc nơi công cộng
- **a right to breathe clean air** — quyền được hít không khí sạch
- **some flexibility** — một chút linh hoạt
- **non-smokers** — người không hút thuốc
- **enclosed places** — nơi kín
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **forced to inhale harmful smoke** — bị buộc hít khói độc hại
- **asthma, heart disease and lung cancer** — hen, bệnh tim và ung thư phổi
- **a smoky restaurant** — nhà hàng đầy khói
- **breathes in harmful smoke** — hít khói độc hại
- **cannot easily change jobs** — không dễ đổi việc
- **especially at risk** — đặc biệt có nguy cơ
- **their lungs are still developing** — phổi của chúng vẫn đang phát triển
- **take priority over the habit of a few** — được ưu tiên hơn thói quen của một số ít
- **change habits** — thay đổi thói quen
- **cut down or quit** — giảm hoặc bỏ thuốc
- **reduce litter** — giảm rác vứt bừa
- **smoke-related illness** — bệnh liên quan khói thuốc
- **limits personal freedom** — hạn chế tự do cá nhân
- **addicted rather than careless** — nghiện chứ không phải cẩu thả
- **designated outdoor areas** — khu vực ngoài trời được chỉ định
- **balance the rights of smokers and non-smokers** — cân bằng quyền của người hút và không hút
- **fair rather than punitive** — công bằng thay vì mang tính trừng phạt

#349 Agree / Disagree · 283 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that a healthy diet prevents illness. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Doctors and health campaigns constantly advise people to eat well, and many people say that a healthy diet prevents illness. I largely agree with this view, since good food lowers the risk of many serious diseases, although a healthy diet cannot guarantee good health on its own.

To begin with, a healthy diet lowers the risk of many serious illnesses. Eating plenty of vegetables, fruit and whole grains and little processed food reduces the chance of heart disease, type 2 diabetes and some cancers. Such foods supply vitamins, fibre and minerals that keep the body working properly, while diets high in salt, sugar and fat are linked to high blood pressure and obesity. A person who replaces fried snacks and fizzy drinks with fruit, nuts and water, for example, may lower their blood pressure within months and reduce the chance of needing medication later. Good nutrition also strengthens the immune system, so the body fights infections more effectively.

Furthermore, the effect on children can last a lifetime. Children who learn to enjoy balanced meals are likely to carry those habits into adulthood and to avoid weight problems. However, diet is only one factor. Genes, infections, accidents, air pollution and stress also affect health, so a person can eat well and still become ill. Exercise, sleep, avoiding smoking and regular medical checks are equally important. Diet should therefore be seen as an important part of prevention, not a guarantee. People should not blame themselves too harshly when illness occurs despite careful eating.

In conclusion, I largely agree that a healthy diet prevents illness, because it reduces the risk of major diseases, although it works best alongside other healthy habits and cannot remove every risk.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a healthy diet prevents illness** — chế độ ăn lành mạnh ngăn ngừa bệnh
- **lowers the risk of many serious illnesses** — giảm nguy cơ nhiều bệnh nặng
- **plenty of vegetables, fruit and whole grains** — nhiều rau, trái cây và ngũ cốc nguyên hạt
- **little processed food** — ít thực phẩm chế biến
- **reduces the chance of heart disease** — giảm khả năng mắc bệnh tim
- **some cancers** — một số loại ung thư
- **vitamins, fibre and minerals** — vitamin, chất xơ và khoáng chất
- **keep the body working properly** — giữ cho cơ thể hoạt động bình thường
- **high in salt, sugar and fat** — nhiều muối, đường và chất béo
- **linked to high blood pressure and obesity** — liên quan đến huyết áp cao và béo phì
- **fried snacks and fizzy drinks** — đồ ăn vặt chiên và nước có ga
- **fruit, nuts and water** — trái cây, hạt và nước
- **lower their blood pressure** — hạ huyết áp
- **needing medication later** — cần dùng thuốc về sau
- **strengthens the immune system** — tăng cường hệ miễn dịch
- **fights infections more effectively** — chống nhiễm trùng hiệu quả hơn
- **last a lifetime** — kéo dài suốt đời
- **carry those habits into adulthood** — mang thói quen đó sang tuổi trưởng thành
- **Genes, infections, accidents** — gen, nhiễm trùng, tai nạn
- **air pollution** — ô nhiễm không khí
- **not a guarantee** — không phải đảm bảo

#476 Agree / Disagree · 282 từ · AI 7.5

Many people think that DIY healthcare information online is risky. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

Millions of people now type their symptoms into a search engine before they ever see a doctor, and many feel that do-it-yourself healthcare information online is risky. I largely agree, although such information can also be useful when used with care.

To begin with, medical advice found online can be unreliable and risky. Websites and social media mix expert advice with rumour and advertising, and people who diagnose themselves may panic over minor symptoms or ignore serious ones. A person who searches online for the cause of a headache, for example, may be convinced that it is something deadly when it is only stress, while another may dismiss a warning sign because a forum said it was harmless. Some sites also sell unproven remedies, and following false advice can delay proper treatment or cause harm directly.

Furthermore, online information cannot replace an examination by a trained professional. A doctor can ask follow-up questions, check the body and arrange tests, whereas a website gives general information that may not apply to the individual. People may also take medicines in the wrong dose or combine them dangerously. However, online information is not always harmful. Reputable health services and hospitals publish clear, accurate guidance, and well-informed patients can ask better questions and understand their treatment. The key is to use trusted sources and to check anything serious with a professional. Schools could also teach young people how to judge the reliability of online health information.

In conclusion, I largely agree that do-it-yourself healthcare information online is risky, because it can mislead and delay treatment, although it is valuable when it comes from reliable sources and is used as a first step, not a final answer.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **type their symptoms into a search engine** — gõ triệu chứng vào công cụ tìm kiếm
- **do-it-yourself healthcare information** — thông tin tự chăm sóc sức khoẻ
- **unreliable and risky** — không đáng tin và rủi ro
- **mix expert advice with rumour and advertising** — trộn lời khuyên chuyên gia với tin đồn và quảng cáo
- **diagnose themselves** — tự chẩn đoán
- **panic over minor symptoms** — hoảng loạn vì triệu chứng nhẹ
- **ignore serious ones** — phớt lờ triệu chứng nghiêm trọng
- **when it is only stress** — khi chỉ là căng thẳng
- **dismiss a warning sign** — gạt bỏ dấu hiệu cảnh báo
- **unproven remedies** — phương thuốc chưa được chứng minh
- **delay proper treatment** — trì hoãn điều trị đúng cách
- **cause harm directly** — gây hại trực tiếp
- **an examination by a trained professional** — sự thăm khám của chuyên gia được đào tạo
- **ask follow-up questions** — hỏi thêm câu hỏi
- **arrange tests** — sắp xếp xét nghiệm
- **general information that may not apply to the individual** — thông tin chung có thể không áp dụng cho từng người
- **the wrong dose** — sai liều
- **Reputable health services** — dịch vụ y tế uy tín
- **well-informed patients** — bệnh nhân hiểu biết
- **delay treatment** — trì hoãn điều trị
- **reliable sources** — nguồn đáng tin cậy
- **a first step, not a final answer** — bước đầu chứ không phải câu trả lời cuối cùng

Opinion

#23 Opinion · 273 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Discuss the role of technology in improving healthcare.

Hospitals today use machines and software that were unknown a generation ago, from scanners to electronic records. This essay will explain two key ways in which technology improves healthcare: by helping doctors to diagnose and treat illness more accurately, and by making care more accessible and efficient.

First and foremost, technology helps doctors to diagnose illness earlier and more accurately. Computer programs can analyse scans in seconds, electronic records let specialists share information, and surgical robots allow smaller, more precise operations. A program that checks thousands of chest scans, for example, can spot early signs of cancer that a tired doctor might miss. As a result, patients are treated sooner and recover faster, and mistakes caused by missing information are reduced. Smaller operations also mean less pain, smaller scars and shorter stays in hospital.

In addition, technology makes care more accessible and efficient. Video consultations bring advice to people who cannot easily reach a clinic, so a farmer who speaks to a heart specialist by video, for example, saves a day's travel and may receive advice weeks earlier. Online appointment systems reduce waiting and paperwork, and wearable devices allow patients with long-term conditions to be monitored at home. These tools free doctors and nurses to spend more time with patients who need them most. Of course, technology must be used carefully, since it is expensive, can fail and requires protection for patients' private data. Staff also need training to use it well.

To sum up, technology improves healthcare by supporting better diagnosis and treatment and by widening access, provided that it is used safely and fairly. For these reasons, it deserves sustained investment.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **unknown a generation ago** — chưa từng có cách đây một thế hệ
- **electronic records** — hồ sơ điện tử
- **improves healthcare** — cải thiện chăm sóc sức khoẻ
- **diagnose and treat illness more accurately** — chẩn đoán và điều trị bệnh chính xác hơn
- **more accessible and efficient** — dễ tiếp cận và hiệu quả hơn
- **analyse scans in seconds** — phân tích ảnh chụp trong vài giây
- **share information** — chia sẻ thông tin
- **surgical robots** — robot phẫu thuật
- **smaller, more precise operations** — ca mổ nhỏ hơn, chính xác hơn
- **early signs of cancer** — dấu hiệu sớm của ung thư
- **a tired doctor might miss** — bác sĩ mệt mỏi có thể bỏ sót
- **treated sooner and recover faster** — được điều trị sớm hơn và hồi phục nhanh hơn
- **mistakes caused by missing information** — sai sót do thiếu thông tin
- **smaller scars** — sẹo nhỏ hơn
- **Video consultations** — tư vấn qua video
- **cannot easily reach a clinic** — khó đến được phòng khám
- **saves a day's travel** — tiết kiệm một ngày đi lại
- **Online appointment systems** — hệ thống đặt lịch hẹn trực tuyến
- **monitored at home** — được theo dõi tại nhà
- **protection for patients' private data** — bảo vệ dữ liệu riêng tư của bệnh nhân
- **staff also need training** — nhân viên cũng cần được đào tạo

#43 Opinion · 284 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Discuss the role of sport in promoting a healthy lifestyle.

Doctors recommend at least half an hour of exercise on most days, yet many people find it hard to stay active. This essay will outline two key ways in which sport promotes a healthy lifestyle: by improving physical and mental health and by building habits and communities that last.

First and foremost, regular sport lowers the risk of serious disease and improves mood. Exercise strengthens the heart, controls weight, reduces stress and improves sleep, and it lowers the risk of diabetes and some cancers. Playing sport also releases chemicals in the brain that make people feel happier, so it helps with anxiety and low mood. An office worker who plays football with friends every weekend, for example, gets regular exercise without having to force himself, because he enjoys the game. As a result, people who play sport tend to have more energy and fewer health problems as they get older.

In addition, sport builds habits and communities that last. Team sports give people friends and routines that make it easier to keep going, since nobody wants to let teammates down, and the competition gives a clear goal to work towards. Children who learn to enjoy sport are more likely to stay active as adults. Clubs also bring neighbours together, reducing loneliness. However, sport is not suitable for everyone in the same way. Competitive games may discourage those who are less talented, and injuries and costs can be barriers, so a range of options, from walking groups to casual games, is needed to include all ages and abilities.

To sum up, sport promotes a healthy lifestyle by improving health and by creating lasting habits and friendships. For these reasons, it deserves encouragement at every age.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **half an hour of exercise on most days** — nửa giờ tập thể dục hầu hết các ngày
- **stay active** — giữ vận động
- **promotes a healthy lifestyle** — thúc đẩy lối sống lành mạnh
- **improving physical and mental health** — cải thiện sức khoẻ thể chất và tinh thần
- **building habits and communities that last** — xây dựng thói quen và cộng đồng bền lâu
- **lowers the risk of serious disease** — giảm nguy cơ bệnh nặng
- **improves mood** — cải thiện tâm trạng
- **strengthens the heart, controls weight** — làm khoẻ tim, kiểm soát cân nặng
- **reduces stress and improves sleep** — giảm căng thẳng và cải thiện giấc ngủ
- **some cancers** — một số loại ung thư
- **feel happier** — cảm thấy vui hơn
- **anxiety and low mood** — lo âu và tâm trạng thấp
- **force himself** — ép mình
- **more energy and fewer health problems** — nhiều năng lượng hơn và ít vấn đề sức khoẻ hơn
- **let teammates down** — làm đồng đội thất vọng
- **a clear goal to work towards** — mục tiêu rõ ràng để hướng tới
- **stay active as adults** — giữ vận động khi trưởng thành
- **bring neighbours together** — gắn kết hàng xóm
- **discourage those who are less talented** — làm nản người kém tài hơn
- **a range of options** — một loạt lựa chọn
- **walking groups** — nhóm đi bộ
- **lasting habits** — thói quen bền lâu

#96 Opinion · 276 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Discuss how sports events can benefit local economies.

Cities compete fiercely to host major sports events, from championship matches to international tournaments, and they expect the events to boost their economies. This essay will explain two key ways in which sports events can benefit local economies: through visitor spending and jobs, and through investment and long-term reputation.

First and foremost, major sports events bring visitors, jobs and spending to the host area. Fans and teams spend money on hotels, restaurants and transport, and temporary and permanent jobs are created in security, catering, tourism and construction. A town that hosts a championship match, for example, may fill its hotels and restaurants for a whole weekend. Local shops, taxi drivers and small businesses all gain from the extra customers, and media coverage can bring publicity worth far more than the cost of advertising. Because visitors often stay longer than planned to see the sights, the benefit extends beyond the stadium.

In addition, events encourage investment and improve the city's image. New stadiums, roads, rail links and hotels may remain after the event and be used by residents, and a successful event can attract future visitors and companies. However, the benefits are not guaranteed. Hosting is expensive, and some stadiums built for large tournaments are rarely used afterwards, leaving cities with debts. Jobs are often temporary, and local people sometimes see little of the profit. The economic gains are greatest when facilities are planned for lasting use and when local businesses are involved from the start.

To sum up, sports events can benefit local economies through visitor spending, jobs and investment, provided that they are carefully planned. For these reasons, they deserve support when costs are controlled.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **compete fiercely to host** — cạnh tranh gay gắt để đăng cai
- **boost their economies** — thúc đẩy nền kinh tế của họ
- **benefit local economies** — mang lại lợi ích cho kinh tế địa phương
- **visitor spending and jobs** — chi tiêu của du khách và việc làm
- **investment and long-term reputation** — đầu tư và danh tiếng dài hạn
- **bring visitors, jobs and spending** — mang lại du khách, việc làm và chi tiêu
- **hotels, restaurants and transport** — khách sạn, nhà hàng và giao thông
- **temporary** — tạm thời
- **security, catering, tourism and construction** — an ninh, ăn uống, du lịch và xây dựng
- **fill its hotels and restaurants** — lấp đầy khách sạn và nhà hàng
- **small businesses all gain** — các doanh nghiệp nhỏ đều hưởng lợi
- **extra customers** — khách hàng bổ sung
- **publicity worth far more than the cost of advertising** — quảng bá giá trị hơn nhiều so với chi phí quảng cáo
- **encourage investment** — khuyến khích đầu tư
- **improve the city's image** — cải thiện hình ảnh thành phố
- **New stadiums, roads, rail links** — sân vận động, đường, tuyến đường sắt mới
- **attract future visitors and companies** — thu hút du khách và công ty tương lai
- **rarely used afterwards** — hiếm khi được dùng sau đó
- **leaving cities with debts** — để lại cho các thành phố nợ nần
- **planned for lasting use** — được lên kế hoạch để dùng lâu dài
- **involved from the start** — được tham gia ngay từ đầu
- **controlled** — được kiểm soát

#301 Opinion · 275 từ · AI 8.0

In your opinion, should countries invest more in health? Explain why.

Ageing populations, rising costs and the lessons of recent epidemics have made health a central political issue. I firmly believe that countries should invest more in health, since healthier people are more productive and cost less in the long run, and since good health is a basic need that everyone shares.

To begin with, healthier people are more productive and cost less in the long run. A healthy workforce takes fewer sick days, works more efficiently and supports economic growth, while people who are ill or caring for sick relatives often cannot work at all. Prevention and early treatment are also much cheaper than late, emergency care. A country that funds screening and primary care, for example, may avoid expensive hospital admissions that could have been prevented. Health spending is therefore an investment that repays itself over time, rather than a pure cost. Countries that ignore it often pay more in the end, when problems become emergencies.

Furthermore, strong health services make a country safer and fairer. Good hospitals, trained staff and reliable supplies allow a country to respond quickly to epidemics, which protects both lives and the economy. Access to care also gives poorer people a fair chance in life, since illness is a major cause of poverty. Admittedly, spending more on health requires higher taxes or cuts elsewhere, and money must be used efficiently to avoid waste. However, the benefits in lives saved, reduced suffering and economic strength far outweigh these costs, particularly as populations grow older.

In conclusion, I believe that countries should invest more in health, because it raises productivity, saves money in the long term and protects the most vulnerable.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Ageing populations** — dân số già hoá
- **rising costs** — chi phí tăng
- **a central political issue** — vấn đề chính trị trung tâm
- **invest more in health** — đầu tư nhiều hơn vào y tế
- **more productive and cost less in the long run** — năng suất hơn và tốn ít chi phí hơn về lâu dài
- **a basic need that everyone shares** — nhu cầu cơ bản của mọi người
- **A healthy workforce** — lực lượng lao động khoẻ mạnh
- **takes fewer sick days** — ít ngày nghỉ ốm hơn
- **supports economic growth** — hỗ trợ tăng trưởng kinh tế
- **caring for sick relatives** — chăm sóc người thân ốm
- **Prevention and early treatment** — phòng bệnh và điều trị sớm
- **late, emergency care** — chăm sóc cấp cứu muộn
- **primary care** — chăm sóc ban đầu
- **expensive hospital admissions** — nhập viện tốn kém
- **an investment that repays itself** — khoản đầu tư tự hoàn vốn
- **respond quickly to epidemics** — ứng phó nhanh với dịch bệnh
- **a fair chance in life** — cơ hội công bằng trong cuộc sống
- **a major cause of poverty** — nguyên nhân chính gây nghèo
- **higher taxes or cuts elsewhere** — thuế cao hơn hoặc cắt giảm ở nơi khác
- **far outweigh these costs** — vượt xa những chi phí này
- **raises productivity** — nâng năng suất

#385 Opinion · 287 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the role of youth sports programs in physical and social development.

Football clubs, swimming squads and school teams give millions of young people the chance to play, and their value goes beyond winning matches. This essay will outline two key roles that youth sports programmes play in young people's development: building physical fitness and health, and developing social and personal skills.

First and foremost, youth sports programmes build fitness and good habits. Regular training develops strength, coordination and stamina, and children who enjoy sport are more likely to stay active for life, which lowers the risk of obesity, diabetes and heart disease. Sport also offers a healthy way to use energy and improves sleep and concentration, which helps pupils at school. A child who struggles to sit still in class, for example, may benefit from a daily run around a playing field. As children spend more time on screens, organised sport offers an important counterbalance.

In addition, youth sports programmes develop social and personal skills. Team play teaches cooperation, discipline and how to cope with winning and losing, and clubs give young people friends and positive role models. A shy teenager who joins a basketball team, for example, often gains confidence and makes friends. Coaches and teammates can also give support to those who face difficulties at home, and young people who are busy with training have less time to get into trouble. However, programmes must be managed carefully. Excessive pressure to win, injuries, high costs and the exclusion of weaker players can discourage children, so clubs should welcome all abilities and emphasise enjoyment and fair play.

To sum up, youth sports programmes play a valuable role in physical and social development by building fitness and by teaching teamwork and confidence. For these reasons, they deserve continued support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **give millions of young people the chance to play** — cho hàng triệu người trẻ cơ hội chơi
- **youth sports programmes** — chương trình thể thao thanh thiếu niên
- **building physical fitness and health** — xây dựng thể lực và sức khoẻ
- **developing social and personal skills** — phát triển kỹ năng xã hội và cá nhân
- **build fitness and good habits** — xây dựng thể lực và thói quen tốt
- **strength, coordination and stamina** — sức mạnh, sự phối hợp và sức bền
- **stay active for life** — giữ vận động suốt đời
- **a healthy way to use energy** — cách lành mạnh để dùng năng lượng
- **improves sleep and concentration** — cải thiện giấc ngủ và sự tập trung
- **struggles to sit still in class** — khó ngồi yên trong lớp
- **an important counterbalance** — đối trọng quan trọng
- **cooperation, discipline** — hợp tác, kỷ luật
- **cope with winning and losing** — đối mặt thắng và thua
- **positive role models** — hình mẫu tích cực
- **gains confidence and makes friends** — tự tin hơn và kết bạn
- **give support to those who face difficulties at home** — hỗ trợ những người gặp khó khăn ở nhà
- **get into trouble** — gặp rắc rối
- **excessive pressure to win** — áp lực thắng quá mức
- **welcome all abilities** — chào đón mọi khả năng
- **fair play** — chơi đúng luật
- **physical and social development** — phát triển thể chất và xã hội

#398 Opinion · 295 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss how public campaigns can change health behaviours.

Advertisements for soap, soft drinks and cars change what people buy, and governments hope that public health campaigns can change behaviour in the same way. This essay will explain two key ways in which public campaigns change health behaviours: by spreading simple messages widely and by changing what people see as normal.

First and foremost, public health campaigns reach millions of people at a low cost per person. Television, social media, schools and posters can spread simple, repeated messages about smoking, handwashing, vaccination or diet, and well-known figures and real stories make the advice memorable. A campaign that shows the real story of a former smoker, for example, can persuade more people to quit than a list of statistics. Messages that give a clear, easy action, such as washing hands for twenty seconds, are more likely to be remembered and followed than general warnings.

In addition, campaigns change social attitudes. When wearing a seat belt or avoiding smoking in public is shown as normal and responsible, people tend to follow the example of those around them, and young people learn what is expected. However, information alone does not change behaviour if people cannot act on it. People may know that vegetables are healthy but lack the money or time to buy them, and messages that lecture or frighten can be ignored. Campaigns therefore work best when combined with services, rules and prices that support the advice, such as free vaccination, taxes on tobacco or healthier school meals. Evaluating results and adjusting the message also improves success.

To sum up, public campaigns can change health behaviours by spreading memorable messages and shaping social norms, but they are most effective when supported by practical measures. For these reasons, they should be one part of a wider strategy.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Advertisements for soap, soft drinks and cars** — quảng cáo xà phòng, nước ngọt và ô tô
- **change what people buy** — thay đổi thứ người ta mua
- **public health campaigns** — chiến dịch y tế công cộng
- **change behaviour** — thay đổi hành vi
- **change health behaviours** — thay đổi hành vi sức khoẻ
- **spreading simple messages widely** — lan truyền thông điệp đơn giản rộng rãi
- **what people see as normal** — điều người ta coi là bình thường
- **reach millions of people at a low cost per person** — tiếp cận hàng triệu người với chi phí thấp trên mỗi người
- **simple, repeated messages** — thông điệp đơn giản, lặp lại
- **handwashing, vaccination or diet** — rửa tay, tiêm chủng hoặc chế độ ăn
- **well-known figures and real stories** — người nổi tiếng và câu chuyện thật
- **make the advice memorable** — khiến lời khuyên dễ nhớ
- **the real story of a former smoker** — câu chuyện thật của một người từng hút thuốc
- **persuade more people to quit** — thuyết phục nhiều người bỏ thuốc hơn
- **a list of statistics** — một danh sách số liệu
- **a clear, easy action** — hành động rõ ràng, dễ làm
- **washing hands for twenty seconds** — rửa tay trong hai mươi giây
- **general warnings** — cảnh báo chung chung
- **change social attitudes** — thay đổi thái độ xã hội
- **wearing a seat belt** — thắt dây an toàn
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **follow the example of those around them** — làm theo tấm gương của người xung quanh
- **information alone does not change behaviour** — thông tin đơn thuần không thay đổi hành vi
- **lack the money or time** — thiếu tiền hoặc thời gian
- **lecture or frighten** — giáo huấn hoặc doạ dẫm
- **services, rules and prices that support the advice** — dịch vụ, quy định và giá cả hỗ trợ lời khuyên
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực

- **part of a wider strategy** — một phần của chiến lược rộng hơn

#445 Opinion · 281 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss the role of arts therapy in mental health treatment.

Painting, music, drama and dance are usually seen as leisure activities, but they are increasingly used by trained therapists to help people with mental health problems. This essay will outline two roles that arts therapy plays in treatment: giving patients a means of expression and supporting wellbeing alongside other treatments.

First and foremost, arts therapy gives people a way to express feelings that they cannot put into words. Painting, music and drama allow patients to explore painful experiences safely, reduce stress and build confidence, which helps those who find talking therapy difficult. A child who cannot speak about a frightening experience, for example, may be able to show it through drawing, and the therapist can then help the child to talk about it. People with dementia or autism, and survivors of trauma, may also respond to music or art when words fail. Creating something can give a sense of control and achievement to those who feel helpless.

In addition, arts therapy supports wellbeing alongside other treatments. Group sessions reduce loneliness by bringing people together, and the focus on creating something shifts attention away from worries and symptoms. Many hospitals now include art or music sessions in their care for conditions such as depression, anxiety and addiction. However, arts therapy is not a replacement for medication or counselling in serious illness, and evidence of its benefits, though encouraging, is still developing. It works best alongside, not instead of, other treatments, and it requires trained professionals so that patients are protected.

To sum up, arts therapy plays a valuable role in mental health treatment by offering a gentle way to express feelings and by supporting recovery. For these reasons, it deserves continued support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Painting, music, drama and dance** — hội hoạ, âm nhạc, kịch và múa
- **leisure activities** — hoạt động giải trí
- **trained therapists** — nhà trị liệu được đào tạo
- **mental health problems** — vấn đề sức khoẻ tâm thần
- **arts therapy** — trị liệu bằng nghệ thuật
- **a means of expression** — phương tiện biểu đạt
- **express feelings that they cannot put into words** — bày tỏ cảm xúc mà họ không thể nói thành lời
- **explore painful experiences safely** — khám phá trải nghiệm đau đớn một cách an toàn
- **reduce stress and build confidence** — giảm căng thẳng và xây dựng sự tự tin
- **talking therapy** — liệu pháp trò chuyện
- **a frightening experience** — trải nghiệm đáng sợ
- **show it through drawing** — thể hiện nó qua nét vẽ
- **survivors of trauma** — những người sống sót sau sang chấn
- **when words fail** — khi lời nói bất lực
- **a sense of control and achievement** — cảm giác kiểm soát và thành tựu
- **Group sessions reduce loneliness** — các buổi nhóm giảm cô đơn
- **bringing people together** — gắn kết mọi người
- **shifts attention away from worries** — chuyển sự chú ý khỏi lo lắng
- **depression, anxiety and addiction** — trầm cảm, lo âu và nghiện
- **not a replacement for medication or counselling** — không thay thế thuốc hay tư vấn
- **a gentle way to express feelings** — cách nhẹ nhàng để bày tỏ cảm xúc

Discuss both views

#25 Discuss both views · 271 từ · AI 8.0 (chấm chéo 7.0)

Some people believe that sport plays a vital role in society. Others think it is overrated. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Millions of people watch or play sport, yet some say that it plays a vital role in society, while others think that it is overrated. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of sport argue that it brings people together and teaches shared values. Teams and fans from different backgrounds unite around a common cause, athletes become role models for discipline and effort, and sport encourages millions of people to be active. A small-town football club, for example, can bring together neighbours of all ages who would otherwise never meet. Sport also gives young people a positive outlet for their energy, and international competitions create national pride and friendly contact between countries. Taking part also improves health, which reduces the burden on hospitals.

On the other hand, critics point out that sport is sometimes given more attention and money than it deserves. Professional sport is driven by money, and scandals such as doping and corruption damage its image. Fan violence and extreme nationalism can divide people instead of uniting them, and public money spent on stadiums could fund hospitals or schools. Media coverage can also create the impression that sport is more important than serious matters such as science or the arts, and it may distract people from social problems. Some athletes earn enormous sums, while many who work in vital professions are paid far less.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that sport plays a valuable role in promoting health and community, provided that it is run fairly and does not take resources away from more urgent needs.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **plays a vital role in society** — đóng vai trò quan trọng trong xã hội
- **overrated** — bị đánh giá quá cao
- **supporters of sport** — người ủng hộ thể thao
- **brings people together** — gắn kết mọi người
- **teaches shared values** — dạy những giá trị chung
- **different backgrounds** — xuất thân khác nhau
- **unite around a common cause** — đoàn kết quanh một mục tiêu chung
- **role models for discipline and effort** — hình mẫu về kỷ luật và nỗ lực
- **encourages millions of people to be active** — khuyến khích hàng triệu người vận động
- **neighbours of all ages** — hàng xóm mọi lứa tuổi
- **a positive outlet for their energy** — lối thoát tích cực cho năng lượng
- **national pride** — niềm tự hào dân tộc
- **critics point out** — người chỉ trích chỉ ra
- **more attention and money than it deserves** — nhận nhiều sự chú ý và tiền hơn mức xứng đáng
- **driven by money** — bị tiền chi phối
- **doping and corruption** — doping và tham nhũng
- **Fan violence and extreme nationalism** — bạo lực cổ động viên và chủ nghĩa dân tộc cực đoan
- **divide people** — chia rẽ mọi người
- **public money spent on stadiums** — tiền công chi cho sân vận động
- **distract people from social problems** — làm người ta xao nhãng khỏi vấn đề xã hội
- **enormous sums** — khoản tiền khổng lồ
- **run fairly** — được điều hành công bằng

#51 Discuss both views · 270 từ · AI 7.0 (chấm chéo 7.0)

Is it better to focus government spending on healthcare or on other priorities? Discuss and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether public money should be focused on healthcare or on other priorities such as education, housing and transport. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of healthcare spending argue that good health is the foundation on which everything else depends. A sick population cannot learn, work or care for children, ageing societies need more care each year, and emergencies such as pandemics show how quickly weak health systems fail. Spending on hospitals, doctors and medicines therefore saves lives and protects the economy. A patient who waits two years for surgery, for example, may lose the ability to work and need far more care later. Delays like this are costly in both human and financial terms. Investing early in staff and equipment can prevent such delays.

On the other hand, critics point out that governments have limited funds and many equally urgent responsibilities. Many illnesses are caused by conditions that hospitals cannot change: damp housing, poor education, pollution and poverty all damage health, so spending on housing, schools and clean air can reduce hospital visits. Families living in damp homes, for example, suffer more asthma, so better housing can reduce visits to hospital. A narrow focus on treatment therefore neglects the causes of illness, and transport and education also improve lives.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that healthcare should receive a large share of public money, because it is essential and growing in demand, but not at the expense of the housing, education and environmental measures that prevent illness in the first place.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **public money** — tiền công
- **focused on healthcare** — tập trung vào y tế
- **other priorities** — các ưu tiên khác
- **supporters of healthcare spending** — người ủng hộ chi cho y tế
- **the foundation on which everything else depends** — nền tảng mà mọi thứ khác dựa vào
- **care for children** — chăm sóc con cái
- **ageing societies** — xã hội già hoá
- **weak health systems fail** — hệ thống y tế yếu sụp đổ
- **saves lives and protects the economy** — cứu mạng người và bảo vệ nền kinh tế
- **waits two years for surgery** — chờ hai năm để phẫu thuật
- **lose the ability to work** — mất khả năng làm việc
- **in both human and financial terms** — cả về con người lẫn tài chính
- **critics point out** — người chỉ trích chỉ ra
- **governments have limited funds and many equally urgent responsibilities** — chính phủ có ngân sách hạn hẹp và nhiều trách nhiệm cấp bách ngang nhau
- **Many illnesses** — nhiều bệnh
- **conditions that hospitals cannot change** — những điều kiện mà bệnh viện không thể thay đổi
- **damp housing** — nhà ẩm thấp
- **damage health** — gây hại sức khoẻ
- **reduce hospital visits** — giảm số lần đến bệnh viện
- **suffer more asthma** — bị hen suyễn nhiều hơn
- **a narrow focus on treatment** — chỉ tập trung vào điều trị
- **neglects the causes of illness** — bỏ qua nguyên nhân gây bệnh
- **prevent illness in the first place** — ngăn bệnh ngay từ đầu

#52 Discuss both views · 282 từ · AI 8.0 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Should individuals be responsible for healthy eating, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

Opinions are divided as to whether individuals should be responsible for healthy eating or whether society and governments should take action. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of personal responsibility argue that people make the daily choices that shape their own health. Nobody can eat on someone else's behalf, and many illnesses linked to diet, such as type 2 diabetes and heart disease, are largely preventable through sensible habits. Adults can read labels, cook simple meals and limit sweets and fried food, and parents set the example for their children at home. A person who chooses fruit and water instead of biscuits and fizzy drinks, for example, lowers their own risk of illness without needing any law. Taking responsibility also respects personal freedom and encourages independence.

On the other hand, advocates of government action point out that individual choices are shaped by the environment in which people live. Cheap, heavily advertised, high-calorie food is available on every street, while fresh produce can be expensive or hard to find in poorer areas. People who work long hours or live on low incomes may have little time or money to cook healthy meals. Governments can use education, clear labelling, advertising rules, school meal standards and taxes to make the healthy option the easy and affordable one. A child who is offered a nutritious school lunch every day, for instance, develops better habits without depending on family income.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that the most effective approach combines official leadership with personal action, since governments should shape the food environment while individuals make the daily choices that determine their health.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **healthy eating** — ăn uống lành mạnh
- **supporters of personal responsibility** — người ủng hộ trách nhiệm cá nhân
- **make the daily choices that shape their own health** — đưa ra những lựa chọn hằng ngày định hình sức khoẻ của mình
- **on someone else's behalf** — thay cho người khác
- **Many illnesses** — nhiều bệnh
- **type 2 diabetes and heart disease** — tiểu đường type 2 và bệnh tim
- **largely preventable** — phần lớn có thể phòng ngừa
- **sensible habits** — thói quen hợp lý
- **read labels** — đọc nhãn
- **limit sweets and fried food** — hạn chế đồ ngọt và đồ chiên
- **set the example** — làm gương
- **lowers their own risk of illness** — giảm nguy cơ mắc bệnh của chính mình
- **respects personal freedom** — tôn trọng tự do cá nhân
- **shaped by the environment** — bị môi trường định hình
- **Cheap, heavily advertised, high-calorie food** — đồ ăn rẻ, quảng cáo dày, nhiều calo
- **hard to find in poorer areas** — khó tìm ở khu nghèo
- **work long hours** — làm việc nhiều giờ
- **clear labelling** — ghi nhãn rõ ràng
- **advertising rules** — quy định về quảng cáo
- **school meal standards** — tiêu chuẩn bữa ăn học đường
- **the healthy option the easy and affordable one** — biến lựa chọn lành mạnh thành lựa chọn dễ và vừa túi tiền
- **official leadership** — sự dẫn dắt của chính quyền
- **personal action** — hành động cá nhân

#105 Discuss both views · 271 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.0)

Some people believe that animal testing is acceptable for medical research. Others think it is unethical. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether animal testing is acceptable for medical research or whether it is unethical. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of animal testing argue that it has contributed to many life-saving medical advances. Vaccines, insulin and surgical techniques were developed with the help of animal research, and a living body is so complex that a drug cannot be judged safe from isolated cells alone. Testing on animals first also protects human volunteers from unknown dangers. A new drug for heart disease, for example, is usually tested on animals first to check for harmful effects before any person takes it. For many serious diseases, researchers argue that no alternative is yet good enough.

On the other hand, critics argue that animals suffer in experiments, and that results do not always apply to people. Creatures that feel pain are confined and harmed for human benefit, and a drug that works safely in a mouse can fail in humans, which means that animals can be both a cause of suffering and a poor guide. Cell cultures, computer models and tiny lab-grown organs are improving, and many people argue that these should replace animal tests wherever possible. Public attitudes are also changing, as more people believe that animals have rights. This shift in opinion puts pressure on researchers to justify every experiment.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that animal testing is acceptable only when no alternative exists, and only under strict rules that minimise suffering, while governments and scientists should work hard to develop and use alternatives.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **animal testing** — thử nghiệm trên động vật
- **acceptable for medical research** — chấp nhận được cho nghiên cứu y học
- **unethical** — phi đạo đức
- **supporters of animal testing** — người ủng hộ thử nghiệm trên động vật
- **life-saving medical advances** — tiến bộ y học cứu người
- **a living body is so complex** — cơ thể sống quá phức tạp
- **isolated cells alone** — chỉ tế bào riêng lẻ
- **protects human volunteers from unknown dangers** — bảo vệ tình nguyện viên khỏi nguy hiểm chưa biết
- **check for harmful effects** — kiểm tra tác dụng có hại
- **no alternative is yet good enough** — chưa có phương án nào đủ tốt
- **animals suffer in experiments** — động vật chịu đau khổ trong thí nghiệm
- **do not always apply to people** — không phải lúc nào cũng áp dụng cho người
- **feel pain** — cảm nhận đau
- **confined and harmed for human benefit** — bị nhốt và làm hại vì lợi ích con người
- **a poor guide** — chỉ dẫn kém
- **Cell cultures, computer models** — mô nuôi cấy, mô hình máy tính
- **tiny lab-grown organs** — cơ quan thu nhỏ nuôi trong phòng thí nghiệm
- **replace animal tests wherever possible** — thay thế thử nghiệm động vật bất cứ khi nào có thể
- **animals have rights** — động vật có quyền
- **experiment** — thử nghiệm
- **under strict rules that minimise suffering** — dưới quy tắc nghiêm để giảm đau khổ

#132 Discuss both views · 285 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Should individuals be responsible for their own health, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

Heart disease, diabetes and many other illnesses have been linked to the way people live, and opinions differ on who should be responsible for health: individuals themselves, or society and the government. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of personal responsibility argue that people make the daily choices that shape their own health. Smoking, drinking too much alcohol, eating badly, sleeping too little and avoiding exercise account for a large share of preventable illness, and no doctor can undo years of unhealthy habits. Motivation also has to come from within: a person who is determined to stop smoking and walks every day is far more likely to stay well than one who waits to be told what to do. Individuals who look after themselves also reduce the burden on the health service and save money. A man who quits cigarettes at forty, for example, may add years to his life and avoid costly treatment later.

On the other hand, advocates of government action point out that individuals cannot control many of the things that affect their health. Clean water, vaccination, safe workplaces and cleaner air depend on public policy, and screening programmes and hospitals require national planning and funding. Poorer people often face higher risks, since they may live in damp housing or have less access to doctors. A vaccination programme, for example, protects a whole community in a way that no individual could arrange alone. Governments can also restrict tobacco sales and give reliable health information.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that governments should provide the system and the safeguards, while individuals use them wisely and take care of themselves.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **linked to the way people live** — liên quan đến cách con người sống
- **responsible for health** — chịu trách nhiệm về sức khoẻ
- **supporters of personal responsibility** — người ủng hộ trách nhiệm cá nhân
- **make the daily choices that shape their own health** — đưa ra những lựa chọn hằng ngày định hình sức khoẻ của mình
- **drinking too much alcohol** — uống quá nhiều rượu
- **sleeping too little** — ngủ quá ít
- **a large share of preventable illness** — phần lớn bệnh có thể phòng tránh
- **undo years of unhealthy habits** — xoá bỏ nhiều năm thói quen xấu
- **come from within** — đến từ bên trong
- **is determined to stop smoking** — quyết tâm bỏ thuốc
- **stay well** — giữ được sức khoẻ
- **reduce the burden on the health service** — giảm gánh nặng cho hệ thống y tế
- **add years to his life** — kéo dài thêm tuổi thọ
- **costly treatment** — điều trị tốn kém
- **cannot control** — không thể kiểm soát
- **safe workplaces** — nơi làm việc an toàn
- **depend on public policy** — phụ thuộc chính sách công
- **screening programmes** — chương trình sàng lọc
- **national planning and funding** — quy hoạch và tài trợ quốc gia
- **damp housing** — nhà ẩm thấp
- **less access to doctors** — ít tiếp cận bác sĩ hơn
- **reliable health information** — thông tin sức khoẻ đáng tin cậy

#151 Discuss both views · 277 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.0)

Is it better to focus government spending on mental health or on physical health? Discuss and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether public money should be directed mainly at mental health or at physical health. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of mental health spending argue that mental illness is common but often neglected. Conditions such as depression and anxiety are hidden, carry stigma and cost society through lost work, broken relationships and, in the worst cases, suicide. Early help is far cheaper than late treatment, yet many people wait months for therapy. An employee with untreated depression, for example, may be absent from work for months and strain relationships at home. Young people are especially at risk, and good support at school can prevent problems that last for decades. For these reasons, mental health deserves a larger share of spending than it usually receives.

On the other hand, critics point out that physical illness is often more visible and immediately life-threatening. Cancer, heart disease and injuries need hospitals, equipment and trained staff at once, and their results are easier to measure. A heart patient who cannot get an operation, for instance, may die within weeks, whatever else the government spends on. Mental health also tends to improve when physical needs are met, since people who are free from pain and disease are better able to cope. Funding for physical care therefore cannot be allowed to fall. Both forms of care are essential to a healthy society.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that mental and physical health are closely connected and that mental health should receive a larger share than at present, while life-saving physical care remains well funded.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **public money** — tiền công
- **directed mainly at mental health** — chủ yếu dành cho sức khoẻ tâm thần
- **physical health** — sức khoẻ thể chất
- **mental illness** — bệnh tâm thần
- **common but often neglected** — phổ biến nhưng thường bị bỏ quên
- **depression and anxiety** — trầm cảm và lo âu
- **carry stigma** — mang tiếng xấu xã hội
- **lost work, broken relationships** — mất việc làm, đổ vỡ quan hệ
- **in the worst cases** — trong trường hợp tệ nhất
- **Early help is far cheaper than late treatment** — giúp đỡ sớm rẻ hơn nhiều so với điều trị muộn
- **wait months for therapy** — chờ nhiều tháng để trị liệu
- **untreated depression** — trầm cảm không được điều trị
- **strain relationships** — làm căng thẳng các mối quan hệ
- **especially at risk** — đặc biệt có nguy cơ
- **last for decades** — kéo dài hàng chục năm
- **critics point out** — người chỉ trích chỉ ra
- **immediately life-threatening** — đe doạ tính mạng ngay lập tức
- **need hospitals, equipment and trained staff at once** — cần bệnh viện, thiết bị và nhân viên được đào tạo ngay
- **easier to measure** — dễ đo lường hơn
- **die within weeks** — chết trong vài tuần
- **free from pain and disease** — không đau đớn và bệnh tật
- **better able to cope** — đối phó tốt hơn
- **closely connected** — gắn bó chặt chẽ

#285 Discuss both views · 286 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that professional athletes earn too much. Others think they deserve it. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Footballers, tennis players and basketball stars can earn more in a week than most people earn in a lifetime, and opinions differ on whether this is fair. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, those who think that professional athletes deserve their pay argue that top athletes are paid according to the revenue they create. Their careers are short, often ending before the age of forty, and injury is a constant risk. Rare talent attracts huge audiences and sponsorship, so clubs, broadcasters and advertisers earn far more than the players, and it seems reasonable that the athletes share in these profits. A player who spends fifteen years training and sacrifices a normal childhood, for example, has earned the right to be well rewarded when success comes. In a free market, pay reflects what people are willing to pay to watch.

On the other hand, critics point out that nurses and teachers, who serve society directly, earn far less. The market rewards entertainment more than public service, which many people find unfair. Enormous salaries can also distort priorities, encouraging clubs to spend huge sums on single players and pushing ticket prices out of reach of ordinary fans. Athletes are role models, and critics argue that extreme wealth may set an unhealthy example to young people about what matters in life. A nurse who saves lives every day on a modest salary, for instance, may feel undervalued next to a player paid millions to kick a ball.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that top athletes are paid fairly by market standards, but that societies should do more to reward essential jobs such as nursing and teaching.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **earn more in a week than most people earn in a lifetime** — kiếm trong một tuần nhiều hơn người thường kiếm cả đời
- **deserve their pay** — xứng đáng với mức lương của họ
- **paid according to the revenue they create** — được trả theo doanh thu họ tạo ra
- **Their careers are short** — sự nghiệp của họ ngắn
- **a constant risk** — rủi ro thường trực
- **Rare talent attracts huge audiences and sponsorship** — tài năng hiếm thu hút lượng khán giả và tài trợ lớn
- **share in these profits** — chia sẻ lợi nhuận này
- **sacrifices a normal childhood** — hy sinh tuổi thơ bình thường
- **well rewarded** — được thưởng xứng đáng
- **a free market** — thị trường tự do
- **willing to pay to watch** — sẵn sàng trả tiền để xem
- **critics point out** — người chỉ trích chỉ ra
- **serve society directly** — phục vụ xã hội trực tiếp
- **rewards entertainment more than public service** — thưởng cho giải trí nhiều hơn phục vụ cộng đồng
- **distort priorities** — làm méo mó các ưu tiên
- **out of reach of ordinary fans** — ngoài tầm với của cổ động viên bình thường
- **role models** — hình mẫu
- **an unhealthy example** — tấm gương không lành mạnh
- **saves lives every day** — cứu mạng người mỗi ngày
- **undervalued** — không được trân trọng
- **paid fairly by market standards** — được trả công bằng theo chuẩn thị trường

#291 Discuss both views · 270 từ · AI 8.0

Is it better to focus government spending on birth rate initiatives or on healthcare? Discuss and give your opinion.

In several countries the number of births is falling while the population is ageing, and opinions differ on whether public money should go to birth rate initiatives or to healthcare. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of birth rate initiatives argue that a shrinking workforce creates serious long-term problems. With fewer young workers, there are fewer taxpayers to pay for pensions and public services, and economies may grow more slowly. Childcare support, parental leave and housing help can ease the pressure on young families who delay having children because of costs. A couple that postpones starting a family until they can afford a larger home, for example, may end up with fewer children than they wanted. If such help makes it easier to have a child, the population may stabilise over time.

On the other hand, critics point out that birth rate initiatives are expensive and their results are uncertain. People decide whether to have children for many personal reasons, and the effect of financial incentives is often small and slow. Healthcare, by contrast, benefits everyone immediately, including the growing number of older people. A healthy older population also remains active and productive for longer, which helps to offset the effects of fewer young workers. Good maternal and child health services can also help families who want children to have them safely. Investment in health therefore offers more certain returns.

To sum up, both positions have their merits; nevertheless, I believe that healthcare should take priority, because its benefits are immediate and certain, although modest family support can be added.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **the number of births is falling** — số ca sinh đang giảm
- **the population is ageing** — dân số đang già đi
- **public money** — tiền công
- **birth rate initiatives** — các sáng kiến khuyến khích sinh
- **a shrinking workforce** — lực lượng lao động thu hẹp
- **serious long-term problems** — vấn đề nghiêm trọng dài hạn
- **fewer taxpayers** — ít người đóng thuế hơn
- **pay for pensions and public services** — chi trả lương hưu và dịch vụ công
- **grow more slowly** — tăng trưởng chậm hơn
- **Childcare support, parental leave and housing help** — hỗ trợ chăm sóc trẻ, nghỉ thai sản và hỗ trợ nhà ở
- **delay having children** — trì hoãn việc sinh con
- **postpones starting a family** — hoãn việc lập gia đình
- **stabilise over time** — ổn định dần theo thời gian
- **critics point out** — người chỉ trích chỉ ra
- **expensive and their results are uncertain** — tốn kém và kết quả không chắc chắn
- **personal reasons** — lý do cá nhân
- **financial incentives** — khuyến khích tài chính
- **benefits everyone immediately** — có lợi ngay cho mọi người
- **active and productive for longer** — năng động và làm việc hiệu quả lâu hơn
- **offset the effects of fewer young workers** — bù đắp tác động của việc ít lao động trẻ
- **maternal and child health services** — dịch vụ sức khoẻ bà mẹ và trẻ em
- **more certain returns** — lợi ích chắc chắn hơn
- **take priority** — được ưu tiên

#367 Discuss both views · 297 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that healthy eating should be promoted through taxation on unhealthy foods. Others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Obesity and diet-related disease are rising in many countries, and some people believe that healthy eating should be promoted through taxation on unhealthy foods. Others disagree. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of such a tax argue that it sends a clear price signal. Higher prices reduce consumption of sugary drinks and snacks, encourage manufacturers to reduce sugar and fat in their recipes, and raise revenue that can be spent on health services. Some countries that taxed sugary drinks saw sales fall and recipes change, which suggests that the policy can work. Taxes are also cheaper to run than many other measures, since they use the existing tax system. A tax on soft drinks, for example, can persuade a company to cut the sugar in its best-selling product rather than pay more. If the money is used to subsidise fruit and vegetables or to fund school meals, the benefit is greater still.

On the other hand, critics point out that taxes on food hit poorer households hardest. People on low incomes spend a larger share of their money on food, and they may simply switch to another cheap unhealthy product, so the higher price alone does not improve their diet. Taxes may also seem unfair, as they punish people instead of helping them. Education, better access to fresh food and clear labels may achieve more in the long run. A family that lives far from a market selling fresh vegetables, for instance, will not eat better just because chips cost more.

To sum up, both positions have their merits; nevertheless, I believe that a tax can be useful if its revenue is used to make healthy food cheaper and more accessible, rather than as a punishment alone.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **diet-related disease** — bệnh liên quan chế độ ăn
- **healthy eating** — ăn uống lành mạnh
- **taxation on unhealthy foods** — đánh thuế thực phẩm không lành mạnh
- **a clear price signal** — tín hiệu giá rõ ràng
- **reduce consumption of sugary drinks and snacks** — giảm tiêu thụ đồ uống có đường và đồ ăn vặt
- **reduce sugar and fat in their recipes** — giảm đường và chất béo trong công thức
- **raise revenue** — tăng nguồn thu
- **sugary drinks** — đồ uống có đường
- **sales fall and recipes change** — doanh số giảm và công thức thay đổi
- **the existing tax system** — hệ thống thuế hiện có
- **persuade a company** — thuyết phục một công ty
- **subsidise fruit and vegetables** — trợ giá trái cây và rau
- **fund school meals** — tài trợ bữa ăn học đường
- **critics point out** — người chỉ trích chỉ ra
- **hit poorer households hardest** — đánh nặng nhất vào hộ nghèo
- **spend a larger share of their money on food** — chi phần lớn tiền hơn cho thực phẩm
- **switch to another cheap unhealthy product** — chuyển sang sản phẩm rẻ không lành mạnh khác
- **punish people instead of helping them** — trừng phạt người dân thay vì giúp họ
- **better access to fresh food** — tiếp cận thực phẩm tươi tốt hơn
- **in the long run** — về lâu dài
- **fresh vegetables** — rau tươi
- **cheaper and more accessible** — rẻ hơn và dễ tiếp cận hơn
- **as a punishment alone** — chỉ như một hình phạt

#373 Discuss both views · 272 từ · AI 7.5

Is it better to focus government spending on public health campaigns or on hospital infrastructure? Discuss and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether public money should be spent mainly on public health campaigns or on hospital infrastructure. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of public health campaigns argue that preventing illness is cheaper and kinder than treating it. Campaigns against smoking, poor diet and infectious disease reach millions of people at a relatively low cost and can change habits that cause serious illness. Vaccination drives and health education stop disease before it starts, so fewer people ever need a hospital bed. A campaign that teaches handwashing, for example, can reduce infections in schools at very little cost. Over time, a healthier population also means lower spending on treatment and more people able to work. Campaigns can also be adjusted quickly when new health threats appear.

On the other hand, advocates of hospital infrastructure point out that people who are already ill need treatment now. Campaigns cannot cure disease, accidents and genetic conditions cannot be prevented, and hospitals need modern buildings, equipment and staff to cope with emergencies and an ageing population. A rural hospital without a scanner, for instance, must send patients on long journeys that can delay diagnosis. Old, overcrowded facilities also put staff under pressure and increase waiting times. A health system that neglects treatment loses public trust, however good its campaigns may be.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that prevention deserves a growing share of the budget because it offers the best long-term value, while hospitals must still receive enough money to provide safe, modern care for those who need it today.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **public money** — tiền công
- **public health campaigns** — chiến dịch y tế công cộng
- **hospital infrastructure** — hạ tầng bệnh viện
- **preventing illness is cheaper and kinder than treating it** — phòng bệnh rẻ hơn và nhân văn hơn chữa bệnh
- **infectious disease** — bệnh truyền nhiễm
- **reach millions of people** — tiếp cận hàng triệu người
- **relatively low cost** — chi phí tương đối thấp
- **change habits** — thay đổi thói quen
- **Vaccination drives** — các đợt tiêm chủng
- **stop disease before it starts** — ngăn bệnh trước khi bắt đầu
- **a hospital bed** — giường bệnh
- **reduce infections** — giảm nhiễm trùng
- **lower spending on treatment** — chi ít hơn cho điều trị
- **need treatment now** — cần điều trị ngay
- **cannot cure disease** — không chữa được bệnh
- **genetic conditions** — bệnh di truyền
- **modern buildings, equipment and staff** — toà nhà, thiết bị và nhân viên hiện đại
- **an ageing population** — dân số già hoá
- **a rural hospital without a scanner** — bệnh viện nông thôn không có máy quét
- **delay diagnosis** — làm chậm chẩn đoán
- **overcrowded facilities** — cơ sở quá tải
- **loses public trust** — mất lòng tin của công chúng

#380 Discuss both views · 276 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer traditional medicine while others prefer modern medicine. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Many people turn to herbal remedies, acupuncture and other traditional methods, while others rely entirely on hospitals and modern drugs. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of traditional medicine value its gentle, holistic approach and cultural roots. Remedies such as herbal teas and massage have been used for centuries, are often cheaper and may cause fewer obvious side effects, and practitioners usually spend time listening to patients and considering their whole lifestyle. For many communities, traditional practices are familiar and trusted, and some, such as acupuncture for certain kinds of pain, have been supported by research. A person with mild stomach trouble, for example, may find relief from a simple herbal tea and prefer it to a strong tablet. Traditional medicine can also be an important part of cultural identity.

On the other hand, supporters of modern medicine point out that it is tested and proven. Treatments such as vaccines, antibiotics and surgery have been checked in trials and save millions of lives, whereas many herbal remedies have not been properly studied and may be ineffective or harmful in the wrong dose. A person with a serious infection, for instance, may become dangerously ill if they rely only on herbs and delay proper treatment. Modern medicine can be expensive and sometimes impersonal, but its evidence base is far stronger, and it can deal with emergencies and serious conditions.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that modern medicine should be the main choice for serious illness, while traditional methods can be used alongside it for comfort and minor complaints, provided that they are safe.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **herbal remedies, acupuncture and other traditional methods** — bài thuốc thảo dược, châm cứu và các phương pháp cổ truyền khác
- **rely entirely on hospitals and modern drugs** — hoàn toàn dựa vào bệnh viện và thuốc hiện đại
- **supporters of traditional medicine** — người ủng hộ y học cổ truyền
- **gentle, holistic approach** — cách tiếp cận nhẹ nhàng, toàn diện
- **cultural roots** — gốc rễ văn hoá
- **used for centuries** — được dùng hàng thế kỷ
- **fewer obvious side effects** — ít tác dụng phụ rõ rệt hơn
- **considering their whole lifestyle** — xem xét toàn bộ lối sống
- **familiar and trusted** — quen thuộc và được tin cậy
- **supported by research** — được nghiên cứu ủng hộ
- **mild stomach trouble** — rối loạn dạ dày nhẹ
- **find relief from** — thấy dịu bớt nhờ
- **cultural identity** — bản sắc văn hoá
- **tested and proven** — được thử nghiệm và chứng minh
- **checked in trials** — được kiểm tra trong thử nghiệm
- **save millions of lives** — cứu hàng triệu mạng
- **not been properly studied** — chưa được nghiên cứu đầy đủ
- **ineffective or harmful in the wrong dose** — vô hiệu hoặc có hại khi sai liều
- **delay proper treatment** — trì hoãn điều trị đúng cách
- **impersonal** — thiếu tính cá nhân
- **alongside it for comfort and minor complaints** — dùng cùng để thoải mái và chữa bệnh nhẹ

#394 Discuss both views · 280 từ · AI 7.5

Should individuals be responsible for their own healthcare costs, or should society/government fund care? Discuss.

The cost of modern medicine is rising, and people disagree about who should pay for it: individuals themselves, or society through the government. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of individual payment argue that people should take responsibility for the cost of their own care. When patients pay something, even a small fee, they tend to use services more carefully, which reduces waste and unnecessary visits. Individual payment can also keep taxes lower and allows people to choose the level of cover that suits them. Competition between private providers may improve quality and shorten waiting times, since clinics must attract patients. A small charge for a routine consultation, for example, may discourage people from seeing a doctor for minor complaints that could be treated at home, leaving more time for those who are seriously ill.

On the other hand, advocates of public funding point out that illness is unpredictable and expensive, so the cost of care should be shared. A serious illness can ruin a family's finances through no fault of its own, and people who delay treatment because they cannot pay often need costlier emergency care later. Public funding protects the poor, keeps the workforce healthy and treats health as a basic right rather than a luxury. A patient who cannot afford cancer treatment, for instance, may lose both health and savings. Shared funding spreads the risk across the whole population, so that no one is left without help.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that society should fund essential care, with modest personal contributions for non-urgent services, because this protects the vulnerable while limiting waste.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **The cost of modern medicine is rising** — chi phí y học hiện đại đang tăng
- **pay for it** — trả tiền cho nó
- **individual payment** — cá nhân tự chi trả
- **take responsibility for the cost of their own care** — chịu trách nhiệm chi phí chăm sóc của mình
- **use services more carefully** — dùng dịch vụ cẩn thận hơn
- **reduces waste** — giảm lãng phí
- **unnecessary visits** — những lần khám không cần thiết
- **keep taxes lower** — giữ thuế thấp hơn
- **the level of cover that suits them** — mức bảo hiểm phù hợp với họ
- **shorten waiting times** — rút ngắn thời gian chờ
- **a routine consultation** — buổi khám thường quy
- **minor complaints** — bệnh vặt
- **public funding** — tài trợ công
- **unpredictable and expensive** — khó đoán và tốn kém
- **ruin a family's finances** — làm sạt nghiệp tài chính gia đình
- **through no fault of its own** — không phải lỗi của mình
- **delay treatment** — trì hoãn điều trị
- **costlier emergency care** — chăm sóc cấp cứu tốn kém hơn
- **a basic right rather than a luxury** — quyền cơ bản chứ không phải thứ xa xỉ
- **spreads the risk across the whole population** — dàn trải rủi ro cho toàn dân

#433 Discuss both views · 271 từ · AI 8.0

Is it better to focus government spending on preventive healthcare or on treatment services? Discuss and give your opinion.

Opinions are divided as to whether public money should be spent mainly on preventive healthcare or on treatment services. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of prevention argue that stopping illness before it develops is cheaper and kinder than curing it. Regular screening, vaccination and advice on diet, exercise and smoking identify problems early, when they are simple and inexpensive to deal with. A cancer found at an early stage, for example, may be treated with minor surgery, whereas the same disease found late may require years of costly care. Preventive measures also keep people productive and independent, and each unit of money spent on prevention can save several times as much on treatment later. Healthy habits learned in childhood can last a lifetime. Prevention therefore offers benefits that extend across a person's entire life.

On the other hand, supporters of treatment services point out that illness cannot always be prevented. Accidents, genetic conditions and infections strike even careful people, and those who are already sick need skilled help immediately, not advice about their future. Hospitals, emergency teams and specialist doctors save lives every day, and the public rightly expects the state to provide them. A patient with a broken spine, for instance, depends on emergency treatment and long-term rehabilitation, not on prevention campaigns. Reducing treatment budgets would cause suffering and anger.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that prevention should receive a larger share than it does now because it offers better long-term value, but treatment must remain well funded so that nobody is left without care.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **public money** — tiền công
- **preventive healthcare** — chăm sóc sức khoẻ dự phòng
- **treatment services** — dịch vụ điều trị
- **stopping illness before it develops** — ngăn bệnh trước khi phát triển
- **Regular screening, vaccination** — sàng lọc định kỳ, tiêm chủng
- **identify problems early** — phát hiện vấn đề sớm
- **simple and inexpensive to deal with** — đơn giản và rẻ để xử lý
- **found at an early stage** — được phát hiện ở giai đoạn sớm
- **minor surgery** — phẫu thuật nhỏ
- **found late** — bị phát hiện muộn
- **years of costly care** — nhiều năm chăm sóc tốn kém
- **keep people productive and independent** — giúp người ta làm việc hiệu quả và tự lập
- **Healthy habits learned in childhood** — thói quen lành mạnh học từ nhỏ
- **last a lifetime** — kéo dài suốt đời
- **cannot always be prevented** — không phải lúc nào cũng phòng được
- **genetic conditions** — bệnh di truyền
- **strike even careful people** — tấn công cả người cẩn thận
- **need skilled help immediately** — cần sự giúp đỡ có tay nghề ngay lập tức
- **emergency teams** — đội cấp cứu
- **save lives every day** — cứu mạng người mỗi ngày
- **long-term rehabilitation** — phục hồi chức năng dài hạn
- **nobody is left without care** — không ai bị bỏ lại không được chăm sóc

#493 Discuss both views · 268 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer animal testing while others prefer alternatives. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some scientists still rely on experiments with animals to test new drugs, while others prefer alternatives such as cell cultures and computer models. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of animal testing argue that it gives results that other methods cannot yet match. A living animal has blood circulation, an immune system and organs that interact, so researchers can see how a drug is absorbed, spread and removed from the whole body, and whether it harms any organ. This is essential for safety, because a medicine that seems harmless in a dish may damage the liver or heart in a living creature. A new painkiller, for example, may look safe in cells but cause serious side effects in a whole body. Regulators in many countries still ask for animal data before trials in people.

On the other hand, supporters of alternatives point out that these methods can be faster, cheaper and more relevant to people. Human cells, lab-grown organs and computer simulations can predict human reactions better than animals, whose biology differs from ours, and they avoid animal suffering. A drug that works safely in a mouse can fail in humans, wasting years and money, whereas tests on human tissue may give more reliable answers. Alternatives also allow thousands of substances to be screened rapidly. This speed can bring useful treatments to patients sooner.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that alternatives should be used wherever they are reliable, with animal testing kept only for cases where no other method can answer the safety question.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **rely on experiments with animals** — dựa vào thí nghiệm trên động vật
- **test new drugs** — thử thuốc mới
- **cell cultures and computer models** — mô nuôi cấy và mô hình máy tính
- **supporters of animal testing** — người ủng hộ thử nghiệm trên động vật
- **results that other methods cannot yet match** — kết quả mà phương pháp khác chưa sánh được
- **blood circulation, an immune system** — tuần hoàn máu, hệ miễn dịch
- **organs that interact** — các cơ quan tương tác với nhau
- **absorbed, spread and removed from the whole body** — được hấp thu, phân bố và thải ra khỏi cả cơ thể
- **harmless in a dish** — vô hại trong đĩa
- **damage the liver or heart** — làm hại gan hoặc tim
- **a new painkiller** — một loại thuốc giảm đau mới
- **serious side effects** — tác dụng phụ nghiêm trọng
- **animal data before trials in people** — dữ liệu động vật trước thử nghiệm trên người
- **faster, cheaper and more relevant to people** — nhanh hơn, rẻ hơn và liên quan hơn đến con người
- **Human cells, lab-grown organs and computer simulations** — tế bào người, cơ quan nuôi và mô phỏng máy tính
- **predict human reactions better** — dự đoán phản ứng của người tốt hơn
- **whose biology differs from ours** — sinh học khác với chúng ta
- **wasting years and money** — lãng phí thời gian và tiền bạc
- **human tissue** — mô người
- **more reliable answers** — câu trả lời đáng tin hơn
- **screened rapidly** — được sàng lọc nhanh
- **animal testing** — thử nghiệm trên động vật
- **no other method can answer the safety question** — không phương pháp nào khác trả lời được câu hỏi an toàn

Causes / Solutions

#29 Causes / Solutions · 300 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 8.0)

What are the causes of obesity? What solutions can be proposed?

Obesity has more than doubled in many countries over the past few decades, and it now affects both adults and children. This essay will analyse the principal causes and propose realistic solutions.

Obesity is caused by an unhealthy balance between the energy people take in and the energy they use. Cheap, energy-dense food is easy to buy and heavily advertised, portions have grown, and sugary drinks add many calories without making people feel full. At the same time, modern life involves long hours of sitting at screens, desks and in cars. A child who spends every evening on a games console and travels to school by car, for example, uses far less energy than children did in the past. In addition, stress, poor sleep and family habits can make the problem worse, and some people are more likely to gain weight because of their genes. As a result, extra weight builds up slowly over years, and in poorer areas fresh food and safe places to exercise can be hard to find.

To address this issue, governments should make healthy eating and activity part of everyday life. School meal standards, daily physical education, limits on advertising of unhealthy food to children and safe play areas shape habits at an age when they are easiest to form. In addition, taxes on sugary drinks, clearer food labels and cheaper fruit and vegetables help adults to choose better, and doctors can offer advice and support before weight becomes a serious problem. A city that builds cycle lanes and parks, for instance, makes exercise easy and enjoyable. These measures cost less than treating diabetes and heart disease.

In conclusion, obesity stems mainly from cheap, heavily marketed food and inactive lifestyles, but school policies, healthier food environments and more active communities offer a realistic way forward.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **more than doubled** — tăng hơn gấp đôi
- **affects both adults and children** — ảnh hưởng cả người lớn lẫn trẻ em
- **analyse the principal causes** — phân tích các nguyên nhân chính
- **an unhealthy balance** — sự mất cân bằng không lành mạnh
- **the energy people take in and the energy they use** — năng lượng nạp vào và năng lượng tiêu hao
- **Cheap, energy-dense food** — thực phẩm rẻ, nhiều năng lượng
- **heavily advertised** — được quảng cáo dày đặc
- **portions have grown** — khẩu phần đã lớn lên
- **sugary drinks** — đồ uống có đường
- **without making people feel full** — không khiến người ta thấy no
- **at the same time** — đồng thời
- **long hours of sitting** — ngồi nhiều giờ
- **screens, desks and in cars** — màn hình, bàn làm việc và trên xe
- **a games console** — máy chơi game
- **stress, poor sleep and family habits** — căng thẳng, ngủ kém và thói quen gia đình
- **gain weight because of their genes** — tăng cân do gen
- **safe places to exercise** — nơi an toàn để tập thể dục
- **hard to find** — khó tìm
- **healthy eating** — ăn uống lành mạnh
- **school meal standards** — tiêu chuẩn bữa ăn học đường
- **daily physical education** — giáo dục thể chất hằng ngày
- **limits on advertising** — hạn chế quảng cáo
- **safe play areas** — khu vui chơi an toàn
- **at an age when they are easiest to form** — ở độ tuổi dễ hình thành nhất
- **cycle lanes and parks** — làn xe đạp và công viên
- **stems mainly from** — chủ yếu bắt nguồn từ
- **offer a realistic way forward** — mở ra hướng đi thực tế

#62 Causes / Solutions · 279 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.0)

How can governments encourage people to exercise more? Suggest practical measures.

Many adults spend most of the day sitting, and physical inactivity is linked to heart disease, diabetes and depression. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on making exercise easier in everyday life and on encouraging people through schools, workplaces and campaigns.

To begin with, governments should make exercise easy, affordable and enjoyable. Free or cheap facilities, safe cycle lanes and walkable neighbourhoods remove the barriers of cost, time and safety. A city that builds safe cycle lanes, for example, makes it easy for workers to exercise on the way to the office, without needing to set aside extra time. Parks, public gyms and pools in every district give people choices near their homes, and subsidised club fees help low-income families. Planning rules can also require new housing to include green space and paths for walking and cycling.

In addition, authorities should encourage activity through schools, workplaces and communication. Daily physical education, with enjoyable activities rather than only competitive games, builds habits that last into adulthood. Companies can be given tax benefits for offering sports facilities or active breaks, and public campaigns can show how small amounts of exercise, such as a brisk walk, bring real health benefits. Equally important, local clubs, walking groups and community events help people to exercise together, which makes it easier to stay motivated. These measures cost much less than treating the diseases caused by inactivity, and they also improve mental health. Small changes repeated by millions of people add up to a healthier country.

In conclusion, improving facilities and everyday environments and encouraging activity in schools and workplaces offer the most realistic way of getting people to exercise more.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **spend most of the day sitting** — ngồi gần hết cả ngày
- **physical inactivity** — lười vận động
- **linked to heart disease, diabetes and depression** — liên quan đến bệnh tim, tiểu đường và trầm cảm
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **make exercise easy, affordable and enjoyable** — làm tập thể dục dễ, rẻ và thú vị
- **Free or cheap facilities** — cơ sở miễn phí hoặc giá rẻ
- **safe cycle lanes** — làn xe đạp an toàn
- **walkable neighbourhoods** — khu phố dễ đi bộ
- **the barriers of cost, time and safety** — rào cản về chi phí, thời gian và an toàn
- **set aside extra time** — dành thêm thời gian
- **public gyms and pools** — phòng tập và hồ bơi công cộng
- **subsidised club fees** — phí câu lạc bộ được trợ giá
- **low-income families** — gia đình thu nhập thấp
- **Planning rules** — quy tắc quy hoạch
- **green space and paths for walking and cycling** — không gian xanh và lối đi bộ, đi xe đạp
- **daily physical education** — giáo dục thể chất hằng ngày
- **habits that last into adulthood** — thói quen kéo dài đến tuổi trưởng thành
- **tax benefits** — ưu đãi thuế
- **active breaks** — giờ nghỉ vận động
- **a brisk walk** — một cuộc đi bộ nhanh
- **walking groups** — nhóm đi bộ
- **stay motivated** — giữ động lực

#142 Causes / Solutions · 285 từ · AI 8.0 (chấm chéo 7.5)

How can governments reduce childhood obesity? Suggest practical measures.

Overweight children are now seen in schools around the world, and they face a higher risk of diabetes, heart problems and low self-esteem. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on healthy food and activity at school and on changing the wider environment in which children grow up.

To begin with, governments should make healthy eating and activity part of children's everyday lives at school. School meal standards, daily physical education, limits on advertising to children and safe play areas shape habits at an age when they are easiest to form. A school that serves fresh meals and gives every pupil a daily sports lesson, for instance, helps children to build habits that last into adulthood. Vending machines selling sugary snacks can be replaced with water and fruit, and cooking and nutrition lessons can teach children how to prepare simple, healthy meals. Because children spend much of the day at school, these steps reach almost every child, regardless of family income.

In addition, authorities should change the environment outside school and support parents. Taxes on sugary drinks, restrictions on promoting unhealthy products to children and stricter rules on fast-food outlets near schools reduce temptation, while safe parks, cycle lanes and affordable sports clubs make activity easy and enjoyable. Equally important, health workers can give advice and support to families when a child begins to gain weight, and campaigns can help parents to understand portion sizes and screen time. These measures cost much less than treating obesity-related disease in adulthood, and they bring lasting benefits for health and education.

In conclusion, improving school food and exercise and creating a healthier environment for families offer the most realistic way of reducing childhood obesity.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Overweight children** — trẻ thừa cân
- **a higher risk of diabetes, heart problems and low self-esteem** — nguy cơ cao hơn về tiểu đường, tim và lòng tự trọng thấp
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **healthy food and activity at school** — thức ăn lành mạnh và vận động ở trường
- **the wider environment in which children grow up** — môi trường rộng hơn nơi trẻ lớn lên
- **healthy eating** — ăn uống lành mạnh
- **part of children's everyday lives** — một phần cuộc sống hằng ngày của trẻ
- **school meal standards** — tiêu chuẩn bữa ăn học đường
- **daily physical education** — giáo dục thể chất hằng ngày
- **limits on advertising** — hạn chế quảng cáo
- **safe play areas** — khu vui chơi an toàn
- **at an age when they are easiest to form** — ở độ tuổi dễ hình thành nhất
- **serves fresh meals** — phục vụ bữa ăn tươi
- **a daily sports lesson** — tiết thể thao hằng ngày
- **habits that last into adulthood** — thói quen kéo dài đến tuổi trưởng thành
- **Vending machines selling sugary snacks** — máy bán đồ ăn vặt có đường
- **cooking and nutrition lessons** — bài học nấu ăn và dinh dưỡng
- **regardless of family income** — bất kể thu nhập gia đình
- **sugary drinks** — đồ uống có đường
- **restrictions on promoting unhealthy products to children** — hạn chế quảng bá sản phẩm không lành mạnh cho trẻ
- **fast-food outlets** — quán ăn nhanh
- **reduce temptation** — giảm cám dỗ
- **affordable sports clubs** — câu lạc bộ thể thao giá phải chăng
- **begins to gain weight** — bắt đầu tăng cân
- **portion sizes and screen time** — khẩu phần và thời gian dùng màn hình
- **obesity-related disease** — bệnh liên quan béo phì
- **lasting benefits** — lợi ích lâu dài
- **a healthier environment for families** — môi trường lành mạnh hơn cho gia đình

#282 Causes / Solutions · 273 từ · AI 7.0

How can governments increase access to clean drinking water? Suggest practical measures.

Hundreds of millions of people still lack a safe supply of drinking water, and unsafe water causes serious diseases, particularly among children. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on building and maintaining infrastructure and on making water affordable, safe and well managed.

To begin with, governments should invest in water infrastructure and keep it working. Pipes, wells and treatment plants bring safe water to homes, simple filters and community-run boreholes suit remote areas, and fixing leaks and testing quality protect supplies. In many cities, a large share of water is lost through damaged pipes, so repairs can increase supply without new sources. A village that is given a protected well and a trained local committee to look after it, for example, can enjoy clean water for years, whereas an unmanaged pump soon breaks down. Planning for maintenance from the start is essential, because many projects fail when the money for repairs runs out.

In addition, authorities should make clean water affordable and protect its sources. Subsidised connections and public taps for poorer households prevent families from drinking unsafe water because they cannot pay, and clear rules with regular inspection make sure that water is tested and that polluters are punished. Equally important, education campaigns on boiling, storing and handling water, together with protection of rivers and groundwater from sewage and waste, reduce disease and keep supplies clean. International aid and partnerships with local firms can help to fund projects in poorer regions.

In conclusion, investing in reliable infrastructure and ensuring that water is affordable and protected offer the most realistic way of increasing access to clean drinking water.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Hundreds of millions of people** — hàng trăm triệu người
- **a safe supply of drinking water** — nguồn nước uống an toàn
- **unsafe water causes serious diseases** — nước không an toàn gây bệnh nghiêm trọng
- **particularly among children** — đặc biệt ở trẻ em
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **building and maintaining infrastructure** — xây dựng và bảo trì hạ tầng
- **affordable, safe and well managed** — vừa túi tiền, an toàn và được quản lý tốt
- **Pipes, wells and treatment plants** — đường ống, giếng và nhà máy xử lý
- **simple filters** — bộ lọc đơn giản
- **community-run boreholes** — giếng khoan do cộng đồng quản lý
- **fixing leaks and testing quality** — sửa rò rỉ và kiểm tra chất lượng
- **lost through damaged pipes** — thất thoát qua đường ống hỏng
- **without new sources** — không cần nguồn mới
- **a protected well** — giếng được bảo vệ
- **a trained local committee** — uỷ ban địa phương được đào tạo
- **an unmanaged pump soon breaks down** — máy bơm không ai quản lý sớm hỏng
- **Planning for maintenance from the start** — lên kế hoạch bảo trì ngay từ đầu
- **Subsidised connections and public taps** — kết nối trợ giá và vòi nước công cộng
- **polluters are punished** — người gây ô nhiễm bị phạt
- **boiling, storing and handling water** — đun sôi, bảo quản và xử lý nước
- **sewage and waste** — nước thải và chất thải
- **international aid** — viện trợ quốc tế

#311 Causes / Solutions · 292 từ · AI 7.5

What are the causes of teen substance abuse? What solutions can be proposed?

Alcohol, tobacco and illegal drugs are used by a worrying number of teenagers, and the habit can damage their health and education for years. This essay will analyse the principal causes and propose realistic solutions.

Teenagers turn to drugs and alcohol because of peer pressure, stress and easy access. Friends who use substances make it seem normal, family problems and school pressure create a wish to escape, and curiosity combined with a lack of knowledge about the risks leads some young people to experiment. A fifteen-year-old at a party where everyone is drinking, for example, may accept a drink simply to avoid being left out. In addition, substances are often cheap and easy to obtain, and advertising, films and social media can make them look glamorous. Teenage brains are still developing, which makes young people more impulsive and more vulnerable to addiction. Early use can then develop into dependence and damage health, relationships and exam results.

To address this issue, prevention should combine education, support and strict control of sales. Schools can explain the real risks, and sessions led by former users can be more convincing than warnings from adults. Counselling helps teenagers with stress and family difficulties, and enforcement stops shops from selling to minors. Clubs, sport and youth centres give young people healthy alternatives and a sense of belonging. In addition, treatment services must be available for those who already have a problem, and parents need advice on how to talk to their children without anger. Prevention is far less costly than dealing with addiction later, and it protects the futures of young people.

In conclusion, teenage substance abuse stems mainly from peer pressure, stress and easy access, but education, family support and firm enforcement offer a realistic way forward.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Alcohol, tobacco and illegal drugs** — rượu, thuốc lá và ma tuý
- **a worrying number of teenagers** — số lượng thiếu niên đáng lo
- **damage their health and education for years** — làm hại sức khoẻ và học tập trong nhiều năm
- **analyse the principal causes** — phân tích các nguyên nhân chính
- **peer pressure** — áp lực bạn bè
- **easy access** — dễ tiếp cận
- **make it seem normal** — khiến nó có vẻ bình thường
- **a wish to escape** — mong muốn trốn tránh
- **curiosity combined with a lack of knowledge about the risks** — tò mò cộng với thiếu hiểu biết về rủi ro
- **experiment** — thử nghiệm
- **to avoid being left out** — để khỏi bị bỏ rơi
- **cheap and easy to obtain** — rẻ và dễ kiếm
- **look glamorous** — trông hào nhoáng
- **Teenage brains are still developing** — não thiếu niên vẫn đang phát triển
- **impulsive and more vulnerable to addiction** — bốc đồng và dễ nghiện hơn
- **develop into dependence** — phát triển thành phụ thuộc
- **damage health** — gây hại sức khoẻ
- **Schools can explain the real risks** — trường có thể giải thích rủi ro thực sự
- **former users** — người từng dùng
- **selling to minors** — bán cho người chưa đủ tuổi
- **healthy alternatives and a sense of belonging** — lựa chọn lành mạnh và cảm giác thuộc về
- **treatment services** — dịch vụ điều trị
- **stems mainly from** — chủ yếu bắt nguồn từ
- **offer a realistic way forward** — mở ra hướng đi thực tế

#324 Causes / Solutions · 273 từ · AI 7.5

How can governments support mental health in the workplace? Suggest practical measures.

Stress, depression and burnout are among the leading reasons for absence from work, and many employees are afraid to admit that they are struggling. This essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take, focusing on laws and standards for employers and on services and awareness.

To begin with, governments should require and encourage mentally healthy workplaces. Laws on working hours and workload, free counselling, training for managers, flexible hours and campaigns against stigma help employees to cope before stress becomes illness. An employee who is expected to answer emails late at night, for example, may develop anxiety long before anyone notices, so limits on out-of-hours contact can protect wellbeing. Employers could be required to assess psychological risks, just as they must assess physical hazards, and tax benefits or public recognition could reward companies that do this well. Small firms need advice and templates, since they rarely have specialist staff.

In addition, authorities should provide accessible services and promote awareness. Affordable counselling and helplines, available outside working hours, give employees somewhere to turn, and mental health first-aid training enables colleagues to recognise warning signs. Public campaigns that present mental illness as a health condition, not a weakness, make workers more willing to ask for help early. Equally important, support for people returning to work after illness, such as gradual return plans, prevents relapse. Such measures cost less than the loss of productivity and the sick pay that result from untreated problems, and they help to retain experienced staff.

In conclusion, setting clear workplace standards and providing accessible services and awareness campaigns offer the most realistic way of supporting mental health in the workplace.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Stress, depression and burnout** — căng thẳng, trầm cảm và kiệt sức
- **leading reasons for absence from work** — lý do nghỉ làm hàng đầu
- **afraid to admit that they are struggling** — sợ thừa nhận rằng mình đang gặp khó khăn
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **mentally healthy workplaces** — nơi làm việc lành mạnh về tinh thần
- **Laws on working hours and workload** — luật về giờ làm và khối lượng công việc
- **training for managers** — đào tạo cho quản lý
- **campaigns against stigma** — chiến dịch chống kỳ thị
- **before stress becomes illness** — trước khi căng thẳng trở thành bệnh
- **answer emails late at night** — trả lời email vào đêm muộn
- **develop anxiety** — phát sinh lo âu
- **out-of-hours contact** — liên lạc ngoài giờ làm
- **assess psychological risks** — đánh giá rủi ro tâm lý
- **physical hazards** — mối nguy thể chất
- **tax benefits or public recognition** — ưu đãi thuế hoặc sự ghi nhận công khai
- **Affordable counselling and helplines** — tư vấn và đường dây nóng giá phải chăng
- **mental health first-aid training** — đào tạo sơ cứu tâm thần
- **recognise warning signs** — nhận ra dấu hiệu cảnh báo
- **mental illness** — bệnh tâm thần
- **a health condition, not a weakness** — một tình trạng sức khoẻ chứ không phải điểm yếu
- **gradual return plans** — kế hoạch quay lại làm việc dần dần
- **awareness campaigns** — chiến dịch nâng cao nhận thức
- **mental health in the workplace** — sức khoẻ tâm thần nơi làm việc

#351 Causes / Solutions · 276 từ · AI 7.0

What are the causes of limited access to healthcare in rural areas? What solutions can be proposed?

People in rural areas often live far from hospitals and doctors, and their health is generally worse than that of city dwellers. This essay will analyse the principal causes and propose realistic solutions.

Rural areas struggle to attract doctors and keep clinics open. Medical staff often prefer cities for higher pay, better schools for their children and more career opportunities, while patients in the countryside face long journeys, poor roads and low incomes. A villager with chest pain, for example, may have to travel two hours to the nearest hospital, and many do not go at all. In addition, rural populations tend to be older and poorer, so their need is greater, while the number of patients in each village is too small to make a clinic profitable. As a result, people delay seeking help, and illnesses are found late, when treatment is harder and more costly.

To address this issue, governments should bring doctors and services closer to rural communities. Higher pay, housing and loan forgiveness attract staff, and training local students encourages them to return to serve their own area. Mobile clinics, telemedicine and community health workers reach remote villages at a lower cost, so that minor problems can be treated nearby and only serious cases need to travel. Improving roads and providing emergency transport would also shorten journeys when hospital care is needed. These measures are expensive, but they cost less than treating advanced disease and the loss of working lives that follows.

In conclusion, limited access to healthcare in rural areas stems mainly from shortages of staff and long distances, but incentives, local training and mobile services offer a realistic way forward.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **live far from hospitals and doctors** — sống xa bệnh viện và bác sĩ
- **city dwellers** — cư dân thành phố
- **analyse the principal causes** — phân tích các nguyên nhân chính
- **struggle to attract doctors** — vất vả thu hút bác sĩ
- **keep clinics open** — giữ phòng khám hoạt động
- **higher pay, better schools for their children** — lương cao hơn, trường tốt hơn cho con
- **career opportunities** — cơ hội nghề nghiệp
- **long journeys, poor roads and low incomes** — quãng đường dài, đường xấu và thu nhập thấp
- **the nearest hospital** — bệnh viện gần nhất
- **older and poorer** — già hơn và nghèo hơn
- **too small to make a clinic profitable** — quá nhỏ để phòng khám có lãi
- **delay seeking help** — trì hoãn tìm sự giúp đỡ
- **found late** — bị phát hiện muộn
- **harder and more costly** — khó và tốn kém hơn
- **bring doctors and services closer** — đưa bác sĩ và dịch vụ lại gần hơn
- **loan forgiveness** — xoá nợ vay
- **return to serve their own area** — trở về phục vụ vùng của mình
- **Mobile clinics, telemedicine and community health workers** — phòng khám lưu động, y tế từ xa và nhân viên y tế cộng đồng
- **reach remote villages** — tiếp cận các làng xa
- **emergency transport** — vận chuyển cấp cứu
- **Treating advanced disease** — điều trị bệnh giai đoạn muộn
- **the loss of working lives** — tổn thất cuộc đời lao động
- **stems mainly from** — chủ yếu bắt nguồn từ
- **offer a realistic way forward** — mở ra hướng đi thực tế

#411 Causes / Solutions · 279 từ · AI 7.0

What are the causes of poor sanitation in urban slums? What solutions can be proposed?

In many fast-growing cities, millions of people live in crowded slums where toilets, drains and rubbish collection are inadequate, and diseases such as cholera and diarrhoea spread easily. This essay will analyse the principal causes and propose realistic solutions.

Rapid migration into cities outpaces the building of basic services. People who cannot afford housing settle in informal areas outside official planning, where there are no sewers, toilets or rubbish collection, and weak local governments lack the money or authority to provide them. In a settlement where hundreds of people share a few toilets, for example, waste can easily reach drinking water. In addition, residents without legal rights to their land fear eviction, so neither they nor the authorities invest in permanent improvements. High housing costs and low incomes keep people in these conditions for years, and children suffer most from the resulting illnesses.

To address this issue, upgrading existing settlements is faster and fairer than clearing them. Toilets, drains and rubbish collection can be added step by step, legal recognition gives residents a reason to invest in their own homes, and community participation keeps facilities clean and maintained. Governments should also build affordable housing and extend water and sewerage networks as cities grow, so that new arrivals are not forced into informal areas. Hygiene education, for instance on handwashing and safe waste disposal, helps families to protect their health at little cost. Health improves without forcing families to move, and the economy benefits from healthier workers.

In conclusion, poor sanitation in urban slums stems mainly from rapid migration and a lack of planning and secure land rights, but upgrading, legal recognition and community involvement offer a realistic way forward.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **fast-growing cities** — các thành phố tăng trưởng nhanh
- **crowded slums** — khu ổ chuột đông đúc
- **toilets, drains and rubbish collection** — nhà vệ sinh, cống thoát và thu gom rác
- **diseases such as cholera and diarrhoea spread easily** — bệnh như tả và tiêu chảy lan dễ dàng
- **analyse the principal causes** — phân tích các nguyên nhân chính
- **Rapid migration** — di cư nhanh
- **outpaces the building of basic services** — vượt nhanh hơn việc xây dịch vụ cơ bản
- **informal areas outside official planning** — khu phi chính thức ngoài quy hoạch chính thức
- **weak local governments** — chính quyền địa phương yếu
- **lack the money or authority** — thiếu tiền hoặc thẩm quyền
- **waste can easily reach drinking water** — chất thải dễ dàng tới nguồn nước uống
- **legal rights to their land** — quyền pháp lý đối với đất của họ
- **fear eviction** — sợ bị đuổi
- **permanent improvements** — cải tạo lâu dài
- **High housing costs and low incomes** — chi phí nhà ở cao và thu nhập thấp
- **upgrading existing settlements** — nâng cấp các khu định cư hiện có
- **step by step** — từng bước
- **legal recognition** — sự công nhận pháp lý
- **community participation** — sự tham gia của cộng đồng
- **affordable housing** — nhà ở giá phải chăng
- **safe waste disposal** — xử lý rác an toàn
- **stems mainly from** — chủ yếu bắt nguồn từ
- **offer a realistic way forward** — mở ra hướng đi thực tế

Extent

#80 Extent · 269 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.0)

To what extent should mental health services be free? Give reasons for your answer.

Many people suffer from depression, anxiety and other mental health problems, yet professional help is often expensive or hard to reach. I largely agree that mental health services should be free, since cost prevents many people from getting early treatment, although there are practical limits to what can be provided.

To begin with, free mental health services remove the cost barrier to early treatment. Therapy and medication are expensive, so many people go without help until their condition becomes severe, while early support keeps them working and out of hospital. A student with anxiety who can see a counsellor for free, for example, may recover quickly and finish her studies, whereas one who cannot afford help may drop out. Untreated problems also tend to get worse, which makes later care more complicated and more costly for everyone.

Furthermore, free services bring wider benefits to society. People who recover are able to work, look after their families and take part in community life, which raises productivity and reduces pressure on hospitals, welfare and even the justice system. Free access also helps to reduce stigma, because seeking help becomes a normal part of healthcare. However, there are limits. Free services cost taxpayers a great deal, demand may increase sharply, waiting lists can grow long and there is often a shortage of trained therapists. Governments may therefore need to introduce them in stages, starting with those in greatest need, and train more professionals.

In conclusion, mental health services should be free to a large extent, because this allows early treatment and benefits society, provided that governments plan carefully for staffing and demand.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **mental health problems** — vấn đề sức khoẻ tâm thần
- **professional help** — sự giúp đỡ chuyên nghiệp
- **hard to reach** — khó tiếp cận
- **mental health services should be free** — dịch vụ sức khoẻ tâm thần nên miễn phí
- **prevents many people from getting early treatment** — ngăn nhiều người được điều trị sớm
- **the cost barrier** — rào cản chi phí
- **go without help** — không được giúp đỡ
- **becomes severe** — trở nên nghiêm trọng
- **keeps them working and out of hospital** — giúp họ tiếp tục làm việc và tránh bệnh viện
- **see a counsellor for free** — gặp cố vấn miễn phí
- **drop out** — bỏ học
- **get worse** — trở nên tệ hơn
- **more complicated and more costly** — phức tạp và tốn kém hơn
- **look after their families** — chăm sóc gia đình
- **take part in community life** — tham gia đời sống cộng đồng
- **raises productivity** — nâng năng suất
- **reduce stigma** — giảm kỳ thị
- **a normal part of healthcare** — phần bình thường của chăm sóc sức khoẻ
- **demand may increase sharply** — nhu cầu có thể tăng mạnh
- **waiting lists** — danh sách chờ
- **a shortage of trained therapists** — thiếu nhà trị liệu được đào tạo

#93 Extent · 276 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 8.0)

How far do you think telemedicine will change healthcare in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

During recent years, phone and video consultations have moved from the margins to the centre of healthcare in many countries. I believe that telemedicine will change healthcare considerably over the next twenty years, becoming a normal part of routine care, although it will not replace face-to-face medicine.

First and foremost, telemedicine brings medical advice to people who cannot easily reach a clinic. Video consultations save travel time and cost, allow regular check-ups for chronic conditions and let rural patients consult city specialists. A farmer who speaks to a heart specialist by video, for example, saves a day's travel and may receive advice weeks earlier. As internet connections improve and more people own smartphones, these services will reach millions who now go without care. Hospitals will also use them to follow up patients after treatment, which reduces unnecessary visits. For busy parents and workers, a ten-minute video call can replace half a day at a clinic.

In addition, technology will make remote care more powerful. Wearable devices and home test kits will send readings to doctors, and artificial intelligence may help with sorting symptoms, so that many problems can be handled without leaving home. However, there are limits. Some conditions cannot be examined through a screen, since a doctor must touch, listen and perform tests. Poorer and older patients may lack reliable internet or confidence with devices, and privacy concerns must be addressed. Telemedicine will therefore complement hospitals and clinics rather than replace them.

In conclusion, telemedicine is likely to change healthcare to a large extent by widening access and saving time, but its use will be limited by the need for physical examination, connectivity and trust.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **phone and video consultations** — tư vấn qua điện thoại và video
- **from the margins to the centre of healthcare** — từ rìa vào trung tâm của chăm sóc sức khoẻ
- **telemedicine** — y tế từ xa
- **change healthcare considerably** — thay đổi chăm sóc sức khoẻ đáng kể
- **a normal part of routine care** — một phần bình thường của chăm sóc thường quy
- **face-to-face medicine** — y học gặp trực tiếp
- **cannot easily reach a clinic** — khó đến được phòng khám
- **Video consultations** — tư vấn qua video
- **save travel time and cost** — tiết kiệm thời gian và chi phí đi lại
- **regular check-ups for chronic conditions** — khám định kỳ cho bệnh mạn tính
- **consult city specialists** — tham vấn chuyên gia thành phố
- **saves a day's travel** — tiết kiệm một ngày đi lại
- **go without care** — không được chăm sóc
- **follow up patients** — theo dõi bệnh nhân sau điều trị
- **unnecessary visits** — những lần khám không cần thiết
- **home test kits** — bộ xét nghiệm tại nhà
- **artificial intelligence** — trí tuệ nhân tạo
- **sorting symptoms** — phân loại triệu chứng
- **examined through a screen** — khám qua màn hình
- **touch, listen and perform tests** — sờ nắn, nghe và làm xét nghiệm
- **reliable internet or confidence with devices** — internet ổn định hoặc sự tự tin với thiết bị
- **complement hospitals and clinics** — bổ sung cho bệnh viện và phòng khám
- **replace them** — thay thế chúng

#213 Extent · 270 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.0)

How far do you think gene editing will affect healthcare in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Gene editing, which allows scientists to change the DNA of living cells, has moved quickly from the laboratory towards the clinic. I believe that it will affect healthcare considerably over the next twenty years, mainly by treating inherited diseases, although its impact will be limited by safety, cost and ethical concerns.

First and foremost, gene editing could cure inherited diseases at their source. Scientists can already change faulty genes in blood and other cells, which may allow treatments for conditions such as sickle cell disease, and trials are exploring therapies for eye disorders and some cancers. Instead of managing symptoms for life, doctors may be able to correct the cause with a single treatment. A child born with a serious blood disorder, for example, might one day be treated once and live a normal life. As techniques become more precise, the range of treatable conditions is likely to grow, and new medicines may be developed more quickly.

However, the impact will be limited. Early treatments are extremely expensive, so only wealthy patients and countries may benefit unless prices fall or public systems pay. Editing the wrong place in the genome could cause new illnesses, and long-term effects are still unknown. There are also ethical worries, especially about changing genes that pass to future generations, or using the technology to choose children's characteristics rather than to treat disease. Strict rules and open debate will therefore be needed.

In conclusion, gene editing is likely to affect healthcare to a large extent by treating some inherited diseases, but safety, expense and ethics will determine how widely and how fairly its benefits are shared.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Gene editing** — chỉnh sửa gen
- **change the DNA of living cells** — thay đổi DNA của tế bào sống
- **from the laboratory towards the clinic** — từ phòng thí nghiệm tiến tới phòng khám
- **inherited diseases** — bệnh di truyền
- **safety, cost and ethical concerns** — lo ngại về an toàn, chi phí và đạo đức
- **at their source** — tại nguồn
- **faulty genes** — gen lỗi
- **sickle cell disease** — bệnh hồng cầu hình liềm
- **therapies for eye disorders** — liệu pháp cho rối loạn về mắt
- **some cancers** — một số loại ung thư
- **managing symptoms for life** — kiểm soát triệu chứng suốt đời
- **correct the cause with a single treatment** — sửa nguyên nhân bằng một lần điều trị
- **a serious blood disorder** — rối loạn máu nghiêm trọng
- **more precise** — chính xác hơn
- **the range of treatable conditions** — phạm vi bệnh có thể điều trị
- **new medicines** — thuốc mới
- **extremely expensive** — cực kỳ đắt
- **Editing the wrong place in the genome** — chỉnh sửa nhầm chỗ trong bộ gen
- **long-term effects are still unknown** — tác động dài hạn vẫn chưa rõ
- **pass to future generations** — truyền sang thế hệ sau
- **choose children's characteristics** — chọn đặc điểm của con cái
- **open debate** — tranh luận công khai

#250 Extent · 273 từ · AI 8.0 (chấm chéo 7.5)

Some argue that investing in sports facilities improves public health. To what extent do you agree?

Councils and governments spend large sums on sports centres, swimming pools and playing fields, and some argue that such investment improves public health. I largely agree, since good facilities make it easier to be active, although facilities alone are not enough.

To begin with, local sports facilities increase participation, especially among children and low-income families. A nearby, safe and affordable pitch, pool or gym removes obstacles of distance and cost, and people exercise more when it is convenient. A new public swimming pool in a poorer district, for example, can give hundreds of children a place to exercise that their families could not otherwise afford. More activity means lower rates of obesity, heart disease and diabetes, as well as better mental health, and children who learn to enjoy sport are likely to stay active as adults. Facilities also provide meeting places that reduce loneliness, particularly for older people.

However, investment improves health only when it is combined with activities and good management. Facilities that are poorly maintained, unsafe or too expensive are rarely used, and a gleaming stadium built for elite competition does little for ordinary residents. People also need encouragement, such as classes, coaching and programmes for beginners, older people and those with disabilities. Facilities in the wrong places may not reach the groups who need them most. Spending should therefore focus on accessible, community-level facilities, along with cycling routes, parks and education about exercise, so that activity becomes part of normal life.

In conclusion, investing in sports facilities improves public health to a large extent, provided that they are accessible, well run and supported by programmes that attract the least active.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **spend large sums on** — chi những khoản lớn cho
- **sports centres, swimming pools and playing fields** — trung tâm thể thao, hồ bơi và sân chơi
- **improves public health** — cải thiện sức khoẻ cộng đồng
- **make it easier to be active** — làm việc vận động dễ dàng hơn
- **increase participation** — tăng sự tham gia
- **low-income families** — gia đình thu nhập thấp
- **safe and affordable** — an toàn và vừa túi tiền
- **obstacles of distance and cost** — rào cản về khoảng cách và chi phí
- **a poorer district** — khu nghèo hơn
- **lower rates of obesity, heart disease and diabetes** — tỷ lệ béo phì, bệnh tim và tiểu đường thấp hơn
- **stay active as adults** — giữ vận động khi trưởng thành
- **meeting places** — nơi gặp gỡ
- **reduce loneliness** — giảm cô đơn
- **poorly maintained** — bảo trì kém
- **too expensive** — quá đắt
- **a gleaming stadium built for elite competition** — sân vận động bóng loáng xây cho thi đấu đỉnh cao
- **ordinary residents** — cư dân bình thường
- **classes, coaching and programmes for beginners** — lớp học, huấn luyện và chương trình cho người mới
- **accessible, community-level facilities** — cơ sở dễ tiếp cận ở cấp cộng đồng
- **attract the least active** — thu hút những người ít vận động nhất

#253 Extent · 271 từ · AI 7.5 (chấm chéo 7.5)

How far do you think nanotechnology will influence medicine in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Nanotechnology, which works with materials thousands of times thinner than a human hair, is attracting growing attention in medicine. I believe that it will influence medicine to a moderate but important extent over the next twenty years, mainly through better drug delivery and detection of disease, although most applications are still at an early stage.

First and foremost, nanotechnology could deliver drugs exactly where they are needed. Tiny particles can carry medicine directly to a tumour, sparing healthy tissue, and tiny sensors may detect disease much earlier than current tests. Chemotherapy, for example, damages healthy cells as well as cancer cells, so a treatment aimed only at the tumour could reduce side effects such as hair loss and weakness. Researchers are also developing coatings that help implants to resist infection and fabrics that can protect wounds. If these ideas succeed, patients will suffer less and recover faster.

However, the influence will be limited in the near future. Many nano treatments remain at the laboratory stage, and testing for safety takes a long time, because very small particles may behave unpredictably inside the body. Costs are high, so new products may reach wealthy patients first, and regulators will require clear evidence that the benefits outweigh the risks. Some effects on the environment when particles are released are also unknown. Progress is therefore likely to be gradual, with a few important treatments arriving rather than a sudden revolution. Patients will still gain from each success.

In conclusion, nanotechnology is likely to influence medicine to a moderate extent through more targeted treatment and earlier detection, but safety testing and cost will slow its spread.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Nanotechnology** — công nghệ nano
- **thousands of times thinner than a human hair** — mỏng hơn sợi tóc hàng nghìn lần
- **influence medicine** — ảnh hưởng đến y học
- **a moderate but important extent** — mức độ vừa phải nhưng quan trọng
- **drug delivery** — phân phối thuốc
- **detection of disease** — phát hiện bệnh
- **at an early stage** — ở giai đoạn đầu
- **deliver drugs exactly where they are needed** — đưa thuốc đúng nơi cần
- **carry medicine directly to a tumour** — mang thuốc thẳng tới khối u
- **sparing healthy tissue** — chừa mô lành
- **detect disease much earlier** — phát hiện bệnh sớm hơn nhiều
- **damages healthy cells** — làm hại tế bào khoẻ
- **side effects such as hair loss and weakness** — tác dụng phụ như rụng tóc và yếu sức
- **resist infection** — chống nhiễm trùng
- **recover faster** — hồi phục nhanh hơn
- **remain at the laboratory stage** — vẫn ở giai đoạn phòng thí nghiệm
- **behave unpredictably inside the body** — hành xử khó đoán trong cơ thể
- **clear evidence that the benefits outweigh the risks** — bằng chứng rõ ràng rằng lợi ích vượt rủi ro
- **a sudden revolution** — cuộc cách mạng đột ngột

#260 Extent · 296 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent should governments regulate fast-food outlets near schools? Give reasons for your answer.

Many children pass fast-food outlets on their way to and from school, and some people argue that governments should regulate them. I largely agree, since children are especially vulnerable to cheap, convenient fast food near their school, although rules should be fair to small businesses.

To begin with, children are especially vulnerable to cheap, convenient fast food near their school. Young people have little money, little self-control and habits that are still forming, so an outlet at the school gate makes unhealthy eating the default. Pupils who buy chips and fizzy drinks from a shop next to the school every lunchtime, for example, take in far more sugar and fat than they realise. Childhood obesity is rising in many countries, and it can lead to diabetes and heart problems later in life. Restricting nearby outlets reduces temptation and supports the healthy meals that schools provide.

Furthermore, only governments can set rules that apply to everyone. Parents and teachers can advise children, but they cannot control what is sold outside the gate, and a single outlet that changes its menu may lose customers to a rival. Planning rules, such as limiting new outlets within a certain distance of schools, create a level playing field and send a clear message about public health. However, regulation is not enough on its own. Pupils can still buy food elsewhere, and small businesses depend on their income, so existing outlets should be given time and support to offer healthier options. Education about nutrition and good school meals are also needed so that children make better choices even when temptation exists.

In conclusion, governments should regulate fast-food outlets near schools to a large extent, because children are vulnerable and habits form early, provided that the rules are fair and combined with education.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **fast-food outlets** — quán ăn nhanh
- **on their way to and from school** — trên đường đi và về từ trường
- **regulate them** — điều tiết chúng
- **especially vulnerable** — đặc biệt dễ bị tác động
- **cheap, convenient fast food** — đồ ăn nhanh rẻ và tiện
- **little self-control** — ít tự chủ
- **habits that are still forming** — thói quen còn đang hình thành
- **at the school gate** — ở cổng trường
- **makes unhealthy eating the default** — biến ăn uống không lành mạnh thành mặc định
- **take in far more sugar and fat than they realise** — nạp nhiều đường và béo hơn họ nghĩ
- **Childhood obesity is rising** — béo phì ở trẻ em đang tăng
- **diabetes and heart problems** — tiểu đường và các bệnh tim
- **Restricting nearby outlets** — hạn chế các quán gần đó
- **reduces temptation** — giảm cám dỗ
- **rules that apply to everyone** — quy định áp dụng cho mọi người
- **cannot control** — không thể kiểm soát
- **lose customers to a rival** — mất khách vào tay đối thủ
- **Planning rules** — quy tắc quy hoạch
- **create a level playing field** — tạo sân chơi bình đẳng
- **small businesses depend on their income** — doanh nghiệp nhỏ sống nhờ thu nhập đó
- **healthier options** — lựa chọn lành mạnh hơn
- **education about nutrition** — giáo dục về dinh dưỡng

#290 Extent · 269 từ · AI 7.5

Some argue that stricter environmental laws improve public health. To what extent do you agree?

Smog over cities, polluted rivers and chemicals in the soil are not only environmental issues but also health issues, and some argue that stricter environmental laws improve public health. I largely agree, although the benefits depend on enforcement and on other health measures.

To begin with, stricter environmental laws protect people from pollution-related disease. Limits on factory and vehicle emissions and on contaminated water reduce asthma, heart disease and infections, and removing lead from petrol lowered lead poisoning in children. Air pollution contributes to millions of early deaths worldwide, and cleaner air means fewer hospital admissions and longer lives. A city that bans the dirtiest vehicles from its centre, for example, may see fewer children treated for breathing problems within a few years. Safe water laws similarly prevent outbreaks of disease such as cholera, which spread quickly when drinking water is contaminated.

Furthermore, environmental laws prevent long-term harm that is hard to reverse. Controls on dangerous chemicals and waste protect farmland, rivers and food supplies, and the healthcare savings can outweigh the costs of compliance. However, the benefits are not automatic. Laws that are not enforced do little, and strict rules can raise costs for businesses and consumers, which may cause resistance. Health also depends on many other factors, such as diet, exercise, income and access to doctors, so environmental laws are only one part of the picture. They should be combined with support for industries that need to adapt.

In conclusion, stricter environmental laws improve public health to a large extent, because they reduce exposure to pollution, but their success depends on enforcement and on wider health policies.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Smog over cities** — khói bụi che phủ thành phố
- **polluted rivers** — sông ô nhiễm
- **chemicals in the soil** — hoá chất trong đất
- **health issues** — vấn đề sức khoẻ
- **stricter environmental laws** — luật môi trường nghiêm hơn
- **improve public health** — cải thiện sức khoẻ cộng đồng
- **pollution-related disease** — bệnh liên quan ô nhiễm
- **Limits on factory and vehicle emissions** — giới hạn khí thải nhà máy và xe cộ
- **contaminated water** — nước nhiễm bẩn
- **asthma, heart disease and infections** — hen, bệnh tim và nhiễm trùng
- **removing lead from petrol** — loại chì khỏi xăng
- **lead poisoning in children** — ngộ độc chì ở trẻ em
- **air pollution** — ô nhiễm không khí
- **millions of early deaths worldwide** — hàng triệu ca tử vong sớm trên thế giới
- **fewer hospital admissions and longer lives** — ít nhập viện hơn và sống lâu hơn
- **bans the dirtiest vehicles from its centre** — cấm các xe bẩn nhất vào trung tâm
- **breathing problems** — vấn đề hô hấp
- **Safe water laws** — luật nước an toàn
- **long-term harm that is hard to reverse** — tác hại dài hạn khó đảo ngược
- **outweigh the costs** — lớn hơn chi phí
- **not automatic** — không tự động
- **Laws that are not enforced do little** — luật không được thực thi ít tác dụng
- **raise costs for businesses** — làm tăng chi phí doanh nghiệp
- **only one part of the picture** — chỉ là một phần của bức tranh

#296 Extent · 285 từ · AI 7.0

Some argue that poor health is the main cause of social problems. To what extent do you agree?

Unemployment, poverty, crime and family breakdown are often blamed on economic or political failure, but some argue that poor health is the main cause of social problems. I partly agree with this view, since illness can trigger a chain of difficulties, although it is not the only or even the main cause in every case.

To begin with, poor health can trigger a chain of social problems. Illness reduces the ability to work and earn, leads to debt and family stress, and may cause isolation or substance abuse. A father who falls ill and cannot work, for example, may plunge his family into debt and stress, and his children may miss out on education and opportunities. Mental illness that is untreated can also lead to homelessness, broken relationships and, in some cases, crime. In poorer countries, widespread disease holds back whole communities, since sick people cannot farm, study or run businesses.

However, poor health is rarely the only cause. Inequality, weak education and unemployment also create social problems independently, and they often cause poor health in the first place, so cause and effect run in both directions. A person who loses a job, for instance, may fall into poverty and then become ill because of stress, bad housing or poor diet. Social problems such as corruption, discrimination and lack of opportunity cannot be explained by health alone. Tackling them requires fair economic policies, good schools and strong institutions as well as health services. Health is therefore a major cause but part of a wider cycle.

In conclusion, poor health is an important cause of social problems, but it interacts with poverty, education and inequality, so I agree only partly that it is the main cause.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Unemployment, poverty, crime and family breakdown** — thất nghiệp, nghèo, tội phạm và đổ vỡ gia đình
- **economic or political failure** — thất bại kinh tế hoặc chính trị
- **the main cause of social problems** — nguyên nhân chính của các vấn đề xã hội
- **trigger a chain of difficulties** — kích hoạt chuỗi khó khăn
- **reduces the ability to work and earn** — giảm khả năng làm việc và kiếm tiền
- **leads to debt and family stress** — dẫn đến nợ nần và căng thẳng gia đình
- **isolation or substance abuse** — cô lập hoặc lạm dụng chất
- **plunge his family into debt** — đẩy gia đình anh ta vào nợ nần
- **miss out on education and opportunities** — bỏ lỡ giáo dục và cơ hội
- **mental illness** — bệnh tâm thần
- **homelessness, broken relationships** — vô gia cư, đổ vỡ quan hệ
- **widespread disease holds back whole communities** — bệnh tật lan rộng kìm hãm cả cộng đồng
- **rarely the only cause** — hiếm khi là nguyên nhân duy nhất
- **Inequality, weak education and unemployment** — bất bình đẳng, giáo dục yếu kém và thất nghiệp
- **independently** — một cách độc lập
- **cause and effect run in both directions** — nhân quả chạy theo cả hai chiều
- **fall into poverty** — rơi vào nghèo đói
- **corruption, discrimination and lack of opportunity** — tham nhũng, phân biệt đối xử và thiếu cơ hội
- **fair economic policies, good schools and strong institutions** — chính sách kinh tế công bằng, trường tốt và thể chế vững
- **a major cause but part of a wider cycle** — nguyên nhân lớn nhưng chỉ là một phần của vòng rộng hơn
- **interacts with poverty, education and inequality** — tương tác với nghèo đói, giáo dục và bất bình đẳng

#306 Extent · 268 từ · AI 7.5

How far do you think animal testing will change in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Animal testing has long been a controversial part of medical and product research, and I believe that it will change considerably over the next twenty years, becoming less common as alternatives improve, although it will probably not disappear completely.

First and foremost, new technology is providing alternatives to animal experiments. Scientists can now grow tiny organs from human cells, use computer models to predict how drugs behave in the body and test substances on chips that copy the function of organs. These methods are often cheaper and faster, and they use human cells, which may predict human reactions better than animals do. A cosmetic company that tests safety on lab-grown skin, for example, no longer needs to use rabbits. As artificial intelligence improves, such predictions will become even more reliable.

In addition, rules and public opinion are moving in the same direction. Many governments already ban animal testing for cosmetics, and research bodies follow the principle of replacing animals where possible, using fewer of them and treating them humanely. Companies know that customers increasingly dislike animal experiments, which gives them a reason to switch. However, change will have limits. A whole living body is far more complex than any model, and regulators may continue to require animal studies for the safety of new medicines until alternatives are proven. Progress will therefore be steady rather than sudden. Even so, the direction of change is clear.

In conclusion, animal testing is likely to change to a large extent over the next twenty years because of better technology and stronger rules, although some use for complex medical research will probably remain.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **animal testing** — thử nghiệm trên động vật
- **a controversial part of medical and product research** — phần gây tranh cãi của nghiên cứu y học và sản phẩm
- **change considerably** — thay đổi đáng kể
- **alternatives improve** — các phương án thay thế tiến bộ
- **disappear completely** — biến mất hoàn toàn
- **alternatives to animal experiments** — phương án thay cho thí nghiệm trên động vật
- **grow tiny organs from human cells** — nuôi cơ quan nhỏ từ tế bào người
- **computer models** — mô hình máy tính
- **predict how drugs behave in the body** — dự đoán thuốc hoạt động trong cơ thể thế nào
- **chips that copy the function of organs** — chip mô phỏng chức năng cơ quan
- **cheaper and faster** — rẻ hơn và nhanh hơn
- **predict human reactions better** — dự đoán phản ứng của người tốt hơn
- **lab-grown skin** — da nuôi trong phòng thí nghiệm
- **artificial intelligence** — trí tuệ nhân tạo
- **rules and public opinion** — luật lệ và dư luận
- **ban animal testing for cosmetics** — cấm thử nghiệm mỹ phẩm trên động vật
- **treating them humanely** — đối xử nhân đạo với chúng
- **dislike animal experiments** — không thích thí nghiệm trên động vật
- **more complex than any model** — phức tạp hơn bất kỳ mô hình nào
- **require animal studies** — yêu cầu nghiên cứu trên động vật
- **new medicines** — thuốc mới
- **until alternatives are proven** — cho đến khi phương án thay thế được chứng minh
- **steady rather than sudden** — đều đặn thay vì đột ngột

#455 Extent · 280 từ · AI 7.5

How far do you think wearable health tech will change patient monitoring in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Watches that count heartbeats and patches that measure blood sugar are becoming common, and I believe that wearable health technology will change patient monitoring considerably over the next twenty years, although it will not replace regular medical care.

First and foremost, wearable devices allow continuous monitoring outside hospital. Watches and patches record heart rate, blood sugar and sleep all day, warn of problems early and let patients with long-term illness manage their condition at home. A watch that detects an irregular heartbeat, for example, may prompt its wearer to see a doctor before a stroke occurs. Instead of a single reading in a clinic every few months, doctors will see trends over weeks, which gives a far more accurate picture of a patient's health. Hospitals could then send patients home earlier, with their condition watched remotely.

In addition, wearables will become smaller, cheaper and more powerful. Artificial intelligence will analyse the data and alert doctors only when something changes, so that patients get help in time and doctors are not overwhelmed. This approach is especially valuable for older people and those with heart disease or diabetes. However, there are limits. Some devices are not accurate enough for medical decisions, large amounts of data may overload doctors, and privacy and security of personal information are serious concerns. Older or poorer patients may also find the technology difficult or too costly to use. Training and subsidies would help to prevent a gap between those who benefit and those who do not.

In conclusion, wearable health technology is likely to change patient monitoring to a large extent by enabling continuous, remote and early detection, provided that accuracy, privacy and fair access are ensured.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **measure blood sugar** — đo đường huyết
- **becoming common** — trở nên phổ biến
- **wearable health technology** — công nghệ sức khoẻ đeo được
- **patient monitoring** — theo dõi bệnh nhân
- **continuous monitoring outside hospital** — theo dõi liên tục ngoài bệnh viện
- **heart rate, blood sugar and sleep** — nhịp tim, đường huyết và giấc ngủ
- **all day** — cả ngày
- **warn of problems early** — cảnh báo vấn đề sớm
- **long-term illness** — bệnh mạn tính
- **manage their condition at home** — quản lý bệnh tình tại nhà
- **an irregular heartbeat** — nhịp tim không đều
- **before a stroke occurs** — trước khi đột quỵ xảy ra
- **a single reading in a clinic** — một chỉ số đo duy nhất ở phòng khám
- **trends over weeks** — xu hướng qua nhiều tuần
- **a far more accurate picture** — bức tranh chính xác hơn nhiều
- **watched remotely** — được theo dõi từ xa
- **smaller, cheaper and more powerful** — nhỏ hơn, rẻ hơn và mạnh hơn
- **artificial intelligence** — trí tuệ nhân tạo
- **alert doctors only when something changes** — chỉ báo bác sĩ khi có thay đổi
- **not accurate enough for medical decisions** — không đủ chính xác để quyết định y khoa
- **overload doctors** — làm bác sĩ quá tải

#472 Extent · 277 từ · AI 7.5

Some argue that stricter food safety regulations protect public health. To what extent do you agree?

Contaminated food can make large numbers of people ill within a few hours, and some argue that stricter food safety regulations protect public health. I largely agree, since strong rules prevent outbreaks and build trust, although they must be fair and enforceable.

To begin with, strict food safety rules protect public health. Inspections, hygiene standards and traceability reduce outbreaks of food poisoning and allow contaminated products to be recalled quickly, which builds trust in the food industry. A restaurant that stores raw meat next to salad, for example, can cause an outbreak of food poisoning that affects dozens of customers. Rules about cooking temperatures, cleaning, storage and labelling of allergens remove many of these risks. Because consumers cannot see bacteria or check a factory for themselves, they depend on regulation to keep food safe, and children, older people and pregnant women are particularly vulnerable.

Furthermore, regulations create a level playing field and support trade. Honest producers are not undercut by careless ones who save money by ignoring hygiene, and exporters need to meet high standards to sell in other countries. After a serious scandal, the damage to an entire industry can be far greater than the cost of prevention. However, strict rules also have costs. Small farmers and local sellers may find paperwork and equipment expensive, and enforcement requires well-trained inspectors. Authorities should therefore apply proportionate rules, give advice and time to small businesses, and focus inspections on the highest risks, so that safety is improved without destroying livelihoods.

In conclusion, stricter food safety regulations protect public health to a large extent, because they prevent illness and build trust, provided that they are proportionate and well enforced.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Contaminated food** — thực phẩm bị nhiễm bẩn
- **stricter food safety regulations** — quy định an toàn thực phẩm nghiêm hơn
- **prevent outbreaks and build trust** — ngăn bùng phát và xây lòng tin
- **Inspections, hygiene standards and traceability** — thanh tra, tiêu chuẩn vệ sinh và truy xuất nguồn gốc
- **outbreaks of food poisoning** — các vụ bùng phát ngộ độc thực phẩm
- **recalled quickly** — được thu hồi nhanh chóng
- **stores raw meat next to salad** — để thịt sống cạnh salad
- **cooking temperatures** — nhiệt độ nấu
- **labelling of allergens** — dán nhãn chất gây dị ứng
- **check a factory for themselves** — tự kiểm tra một nhà máy
- **particularly vulnerable** — đặc biệt dễ tổn thương
- **create a level playing field** — tạo sân chơi bình đẳng
- **undercut by careless ones** — bị doanh nghiệp cẩu thả cạnh tranh giá
- **ignoring hygiene** — phớt lờ vệ sinh
- **a serious scandal** — một bê bối nghiêm trọng
- **paperwork and equipment** — giấy tờ và thiết bị
- **well-trained inspectors** — thanh tra được đào tạo tốt
- **proportionate rules** — quy định tương xứng
- **focus inspections on the highest risks** — tập trung thanh tra vào rủi ro cao nhất
- **destroying livelihoods** — phá huỷ sinh kế